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No Half Truths

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DELHI WILL NOT BE HELD HOSTAGE: CM P3



'COUNTRY WILL BE RUN FROM PARLIAMENT, NOT STREETS' P5

'JAYA JI WAS THE ORIGINAL CHOICE' P14



OVER 7K DETAINED, INCLUDING CJP LEADER, 4 EX-CMs; HEAVY SECURITY FOILS PLANNED JANTAR MANTAR MOBILISATION

CAPITAL UNDER LOCK AND STIR

NARESH BISWANI/ANAMTA FATIMA/PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, October 10

As massive unprecedented police crackdown tried to foil the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) called protest of young students and activists in the national Capital on Saturday at Jantar Mantar which remained out of bounds, thousands of protesters took to demonstrations and slogan chanting in a series of scattered protests in other areas.

Detention of over 7,000 protesters, including CJP leader Abhijit Dipke, four former chief ministers and YouTuber Dhruv Rathee, helped the government thwart a planned mass mobilisation at Jantar Mantar, a designated protest site in the heart of Delhi, to press for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

Jantar Mantar wore a deserted look throughout the day, with the deployment of over 30,000 security personnel and multi-tiered barricades in Lutyens' Delhi to keep the protesters away from the area.

Opposition parties likened the situation to one worse than the Emergency, with Congress leader Rahul Gandhi urging the youth to "keep protesting" and asserting that "we are going to ensure that this regime and the people who have attacked the Constitution are defeated".

Several opposition leaders, including former chief ministers Arvind Kejriwal (AAP), Mamata Banerjee (TMC), Pinarayi Vijayan (CPI-M) and Manik Sarkar (CPI-M), were detained from multiple locations across the capital as they tried to join the protest called by the CJP.

"This has gone beyond an Emergency; it has become a Super Emergency," Trinamool Congress (TMC) chief Banerjee said. Several CONTINUED ON P6

KEY POINTS

- Traffic curbs in Delhi on Sunday amid CJP's fresh protest call; diversions at 30 key points
- Delhi Metro reopens 45 stations after 25-hour closure
- New Delhi virtually turned khaki with the deployment of over 30,000 police and paramilitary personnel ahead of the CJP protest



» DELHI POLICE PERSONNEL INJURED DURING DETENTION OF PROTESTERS; STONES HURLED



A crowd of demonstrators gathers during a protest demonstration organised by the CJP PTI







DIPKE
THIS IS DICTATORSHIP AS DELHI POLICE HAS ENTERED IN THE FLIGHT TO ARREST US. WE ARE HERE TO BE ARRESTED, COME AND ARREST US

BJP CHIEF
GOVT WILL DEAL WITH ANARCHISTS STERNLY

MAMATA
ALMOST LIKE KIDNAPPING, SITUATION BEYOND EMERGENCY

KEJRIWAL
PROTEST WHERE YOU'RE STOPPED, TURN COUNTRY INTO JANTAR MANTAR

PATRA
THERE WERE ATTEMPTS TO INCITE VIOLENCE, PHYSICAL ALTERCATIONS AND STREET BATTLES HERE. IT REMAINED A FLOP SHOW

SC to hold spl Sunday sitting

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court will hear on Sunday a plea seeking initiation of contempt proceedings against authorities for alleged blatant violation of the court's direction to ensure no complete prohibition on metro and trains services in Delhi due to the CJP protest.

According to the cause list of October 11 uploaded on the apex court website, the plea would come up for hearing before a bench of justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

The plea, filed by advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi, has arrayed Union Home Secretary CONTINUED ON P6

CJP's Jantar Mantar round 2 today

NEW DELHI: The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Saturday vowed to continue protests against alleged electoral roll irregularities until Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar resigns, announcing another demonstration at Jantar Mantar at 10 am on Sunday, even as the Delhi Traffic Police warned of possible restrictions across New Delhi and central Delhi. Addressing a press conference after police detained protesters, activists and political leaders during Saturday's demonstrations, Ajinkya Shinde, the CJP's national organisation in-charge, said the party would not retreat despite the detentions.

"The government must have thought we will return home after CONTINUED ON P6

Stir-survival kit: Lessons from July



NEW DELHI: With digital posters, political artwork and advice on how to protect themselves, many protesters who took part in the July demonstration returned to support those joining the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) latest stir in Delhi on Saturday, hoping to take part in a protest that unfolded amid heavy security and mass detentions. Those who had experienced the earlier demonstration advised newcomers to carry at least two masks, swimming goggles, raincoats and clothes they would be comfortable getting wet in, anticipating possible police action via their posters. SEE P3

Briefs

NIA to probe mid-air attack on Machchhar

NEW DELHI: The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has registered a case to probe last month's mid-air cockpit attack on Captain Smit Machchhar aboard a flydubai flight, officials said on Saturday. The case has been registered under the relevant provisions of the Anti-Hijacking Act, 2016, and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967, they said. SEE P6

Delhi court refuses to cancel Sharjeel's bail

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Saturday held that student activist Sharjeel Imam, accused in the 2020 northeast Delhi riots larger conspiracy case, "apparently flouted" a condition of his interim bail by coming into contact with media, but refused to cancel his bail as he was already on his way to surrender. Additional Sessions Judge Sameer Bajpai passed an order on an application filed by the Delhi Police seeking cancellation of Imam's interim bail.

Imam was granted interim bail for seven days from October 4 to 10 by an order dated September 22 to attend his cousin's wedding. CONTINUED ON P6

RAJPUROHIT APPOINTED DY EC

Bureaucratic reshuffle: Govt moves 27 officers

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 10

Senior bureaucrat Prakash Rajpurohit has been appointed as Deputy Election Commissioner as part of a major bureaucratic reshuffle effected by the Centre on Saturday.

Rajpurohit, a 2010 batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer of Rajasthan cadre, has been appointed to the post for a tenure up to April 8, 2030, in place of Sanjay Kumar, according to a Personnel Ministry order.

Vivek Khare, a 1996 batch Indian Telecom Service officer, will be Joint Secretary, National Testing Agency (NTA), it said.

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) has approved appointments CONTINUED ON P6

HIGHLIGHTS

- Vivek Khare, a 1996 batch Indian Telecom Service officer, will be Joint Secretary, National Testing Agency (NTA)
- Ravi Shanakar, Chittaranjan Dash, P Manoj Kumar and Abhishek Bhagotia have been appointed as joint secretaries in the Ministry of Home Affairs
- Mohammed Y Safirulla K and Ritu Sharma will be joint secretaries in the Department of Health and Family Welfare

Oct 12: INDIA's date with Delhi

To hold major protest to protect voting rights

MPOST BUREAU
Alappuzha (Keralam)/ New Delhi, October 10

AICC general secretary K C Venugopal said the INDIA bloc would stage a major protest in Delhi on Monday as part of its continuing fight to protect people's voting rights.

Talking to reporters here on Saturday, he said the bloc recently met the President to convey its concerns on the matter and would also meet the Chief Justice of India on Monday.

Venugopal alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah's attempts to protect Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar would lead to their downfall. The Congress and the INDIA bloc would continue their struggle until the electoral process and system became free and fair, he said.

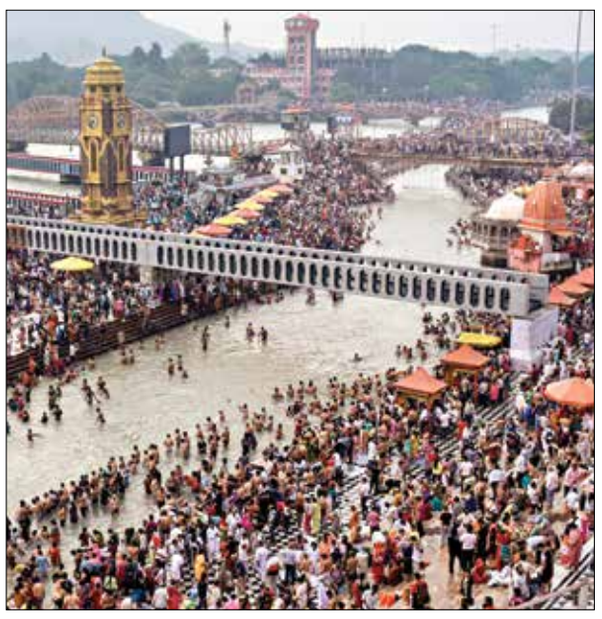
> THE CONGRESS AND THE INDIA BLOC WOULD CONTINUE THEIR STRUGGLE UNTIL THE ELECTORAL PROCESS AND SYSTEM BECAME FREE AND FAIR

He said the Congress had intervened cautiously against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Keralam, and referred to the controversy over the BJP's election symbol, the lotus, appearing on the Election Commission's letterhead

Meanwhile, former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee decided to join the Monday protest march to the Supreme Court as part of the INDIA alliance. The national general secretary of TMC, Abhishek Banerjee, who had left for Kolkata, would also return to Delhi to join the rally, as per reports.

The planned rally is seen as another step in the Opposition's protest action over the current controversy CONTINUED ON P6

RITUAL DIP



People take a holy dip in the Ganga river on the occasion of 'Pitru Visarjan Amavasya', at Har Ki Pauri ghat, in Haridwar, Uttarakhand, on Saturday PTI

TRUMP SPRINGS SURPRISE WITH RUSSIA DIESEL DEAL AFTER PUTIN TALKS

Oil you need is Russia

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, October 10

President Donald Trump struck a deal with Russia for the supply of diesel to the US and global markets, weeks after the US Congress authorised him to impose steep tariffs on top purchasers of oil and gas from Moscow.

Trump announced the deal on Friday after a phone call with Russian President Vladimir Putin, a move that drew sharp criticism from Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, Democratic leaders and a section of Republicans.



Minutes after Trump's announcement on Truth Social, the US Department of Treasury lifted sanctions on Russia for supplying diesel to the global market, including the US until April 7 next year.

Trump's surprise announcement came weeks after the US Congress passed a law on September 16, seeking to impose steep tariffs against top purchasers of Russian oil and gas.

"I have just concluded a highly successful discussion with President Vladimir Putin of Russia, wherein it was agreed that Russia will immediately supply over 300,000 tons of Diesel Fuel CONTINUED ON P6

DIESEL DIPLOMACY

- Trump announced the deal on Friday after a phone call with Russian President Vladimir Putin
- A move that drew sharp criticism from Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, Democratic leaders and a section of Republicans
- Minutes after Trump's announcement on Truth Social, the US Department of Treasury lifted sanctions on Russia for supplying diesel to the global market

Musk ups attack on Ambani

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 10

Elon Musk on Saturday continued his extraordinary swipes at Indian industrialist Mukesh Ambani, sharing screenshots of media reports that alleged Reliance-funded firm helped boost BJP campaigns on social media and a Reliance-linked company made large political donations to the ruling party.

The latest post by Musk on X featured an Al Jazeera report from 2022 headlined "How a Reliance-funded firm boosts BJP's campaigns on Facebook" and an archived Indian Express report from 2024 on Qwik Supply, which



SHARES REPORTS ON ALLEGED RELIANCE LINKS TO BJP CAMPAIGNS, DONATIONS

reported that the Reliance-linked firm donated Rs 385 crore to the BJP and Rs 25 crore to the Shiv Sena through electoral bonds.

The latest post comes amid Musk's scathing criticism of Mukesh Ambani over a persistent delay in the launch of Starlink satellite broadband services in India.

Reliance has not publicly responded to Musk's allegations, while the government has maintained that the country's authorisation framework for telecom and satellite services is "fair and non-discriminatory" and that any suggestion that it was being applied selectively was "baseless and misconceived".

At the India Mobile Congress this week, as Musk's dramatic confrontations and swipes played out on X in the backdrop of India's swanky annual showcase of its telecom CONTINUED ON P6

TIGHTENS RULES GOVERNING FOREX DERIVATIVES TRADES

Rupee depreciation: RBI announcs special dollar window for 3 OMCs

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, October 10

With the rupee continuing to be under pressure, the Reserve Bank on Saturday stepped in with moves aimed at bolstering the currency, including creating a special window for oil marketing companies which will take the dollar demand away from the spot market.

In a slew of notifications early morning on a weekend, the RBI also tightened rules governing forex derivatives trades, aiming to curtail speculative bets against the rupee and asked banks to create a 20 per cent reserve for dollar purchases of over $2 million.

The rupee gained 17 paise against the dollar on Friday to close at 96.71 against the dollar, but has been hovering very close to its lifetime low of 96.96 seen in May this year. The forex kitty has declined over $50 billion over the last few weeks and stood at $734 billion as on October 2.

The special window for three state-run OMCs, who are one of the biggest consumers for the dollar given their crude import bill requirements, has been undertaken on the basis of assessment of "current market conditions", the central bank said.



KEY POINTS

- Reserve Bank also asked banks to create a 20 per cent reserve for dollar purchases of over $2 million
- The special window for three state-run OMCs, who are one of the biggest consumers for the dollar given their crude import bill requirements, has been undertaken on the basis of 'current market conditions'

"Under the facility, the Reserve Bank will undertake sale of $to the public sector OMCs through designated bank/s," it said, adding that the facility for Indian Oil Corporation, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation and Bharat Petroleum Corporation will come in effect from October 12.

During the 'taper tantrum' episode of 2013, the RBI had initiated measures to keep the OMCs' demand out of the forex market to stave-off the pressure on the rupee, which was on a depreciation spree then.

Over the last few months, the central bank has acted with a slew of measures to arrest the fall, including creating a concessional swap window through which banks have mobilised nearly $133 billion in diaspora deposits. However, after some stabilising, the currency has continued to be under pressure.

Experts said factors, including foreign investor, outflows due to lack of artificial intelligence themed stocks in Indian markets, hardening of rates in overseas markets, which offers relatively strong and risk-free returns, and also tightening by other central banks has led to the pressures on the rupee.

On Wednesday, Governor Sanjay Malhotra had assured that the RBI will help stabilise the rupee, which he said was undervalued, and help the currency find its correct value.

In another set of measures announced on Saturday on the derivatives front, the RBI said authorised dealers (AD) should not permit users to rebook any foreign exchange derivative contract involving the INR, whether deliverable or non-deliverable, which has been cancelled.

An AD may continue to permit users to rollover foreign exchange derivative contracts on maturity, it clarified.

The threshold for taking positions without requirement to establish the existence of underlying has been reduced to $5 million from $100 million, the RBI said in a notification addressed to ADs.

Additionally, the RBI has also asked ADs to maintain a Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve (FERR) for foreign exchange derivative contracts involving INR, which will be equal to 20 per cent of the INR equivalent of the notional amount of each derivative contract.

The FERR shall be deposited and maintained by way of cash in India with the Reserve Bank on a daily basis and shall be maintained until the termination of the contract, it said.

Ownership dispute surfaces in Venu Srinivasan family on TVS ownership

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 10

Significant differences have surfaced within industrialist Venu Srinivasan's family over the interpretation of ownership and succession arrangements in TVS Motor Company and its holding firm TVS Holdings Ltd, with matriarch Mallika Srinivasan learnt to be pushing for an amicable & equitable settlement between her children, industry sources said.

Mallika Srinivasan, mother of Lakshmi Venu and Sudarshan Venu, is encouraging dialogue within the family to reach a fair, amicable settlement of wealth, amid differences over ownership of business assets in the Venu Srinivasan family, sources said.

Venu Srinivasan, his wife Mallika Srinivasan, their daughter Lakshmi Venu, and son Sudarshan Venu represent the third and fourth generations of T V Sundaram Iyengar, the founder of the TVS Group.

Differences reportedly emerged within the promoter family in April 2025, when TVS Holdings disclosed that Sudarshan Venu, Chairman and Managing Director of the flagship entity TVS Motor Company, was named a Significant Beneficial Owner through trust structures.



Venu Srinivasan

Daughter Lakshmi Venu, who heads Sundaram-Clayton Ltd (SCL), an automotive component manufacturing firm, is seeking her rights. She has also consistently sought discussions and dialogue to reach a fair settlement of family wealth, they said.

The family executed an MoU in March 2024; however, it covers the use of the TVS brand across different business segments and a non-compete agreement.

"While management of these businesses is clear, the MoU entered into in 2024 only deals with brand usage and non-compete. It does not deal with economic settlement or a valuation-based division of family wealth," they said.

The Venu Srinivasan family controls key businesses, including TVS Holdings, TVS Motor Company, TVS Credit and SCL.

The TVS group did not respond to an e-mail by the time the story was filed.

Lakshmi has sought a fair settlement of the family's wealth, citing the 2020 division of the larger TVS family business as a possible model for resolving the differences. In that arrangement, the broader TVS family divided assets after valuation and reached an agreement among its different branches.

In 2020, the 115-year-old TVS industrial group was divided among the different branches of the family of founder T V Sundaram Iyengar. The settlement involved valuing the assets, dividing them on mutually agreed terms and compensating family members. As part of the arrangement, the Venu Srinivasan family assumed control of key group companies.

Mallika is understood to be encouraging family members to sit together and work toward an equitable resolution rather than let the differences escalate.

As per TVS Holdings' annual report, the family/promoter holds 74.45 per cent stake in TVS Holdings Ltd. Venu Srinivasan holds 66.55 per cent among that through VS Trust.

D-Mart profit rises 8.5% to ₹743 crore in Q2

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 10

Avenue Supermarts Ltd, which owns and operates the retail chain D-Mart, has reported an increase of 8.5 per cent in consolidated net profit at Rs 742.98 crore for the September quarter of current fiscal, on a year-on-year basis.

The company had posted a net profit of Rs 684.85 crore in the July-September quarter a year ago, according to a regulatory filing from Avenue Supermarts.

Its revenue from operations was up 17.8 per cent to Rs 19,644 crore during the quarter under review. It was at Rs 16,676.30 crore in the corresponding quarter in the previous fiscal year.

Total expenses of Avenue Supermarts during the September quarter were up 18.3 per cent to Rs 18,632.70 crore.

Avenue Supermarts' total income, which includes other income, was at Rs 19,657.54 crore, up 17.73 per cent in the September quarter.

In the first half of current financial year (H1/FY27) Avenue Supermarts' total income was at Rs 38,477.85 crore, up 16.47 per cent.

India-US trade pact to reflect changed circumstances: Goyal

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 10

The proposed India-US interim trade agreement will be finalised keeping changed circumstances in mind, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Saturday, adding that negotiations are underway with several other countries and regional blocs.

The two countries announced a framework for an interim trade agreement in February. However, changing circumstances have prompted further discussions on the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement (BTA), Goyal said. India is seeking lower tariffs for its goods than those faced by competitors in the US market.

Earlier this month, Goyal met US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer on the sidelines of the G20 trade ministers' meeting in Milwaukee to discuss trade-related issues.

The minister said negotiations with Canada were progressing faster, while talks with the South African Customs Union (SACU) would begin soon. Discussions are also underway with Israel, Chile, the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) & the Eurasian Economic Union. Trade negotiations with Mexico are scheduled to begin next week.

Goyal added that the UK and Canadian trade ministers would visit India next week. The UK minister will attend the India-UK Joint Economic and Trade Committee (JETCO) meeting. India and the United Kingdom implemented a trade agreement in July.

RBI may hike repo rate by 75-100 bps: Report

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, October 10

The RBI could raise the repo rate by 75-100 basis points in the current tightening cycle, with inflation expected to remain elevated before easing from the next financial year, according to an SBI Capital Markets report.

SBI Caps said gradual rate increases remain the base case, although a larger hike in December 2026 cannot be ruled out depending on inflation readings for September and October.

The report said the Monetary Policy Committee's 25-basis-point repo rate hike and its shift in stance from "Neutral" to "Calibrated Tightening" signal a stronger focus on containing inflation.

It expects the policy cycle to turn around in the first quarter of FY28 as the growth-inflation balance evolves.

Consumer inflation is expected to peak in the third quarter of FY27, while wholesale price inflation could begin easing from March 2027 as favourable base effects set in. Consumer price inflation is likely to trend below 5 per cent year-on-year beyond Q1FY28, the report said.

India's economic growth has remained strong, with real gross domestic product (GDP) expanding 7.8 per cent year-on-year in Q1FY27, exceeding market expectations of 7.1 per cent.

Manufacturing grew 9.2 per cent, while gross fixed capital formation rose 11.9 per cent during the quarter.

However, the brokerage flagged risks to consumption in the second half of FY27, including rising borrowing costs, subdued rural sentiment and weaker kharif sowing.

It also warned that prolonged geopolitical conflicts and crude oil prices around $100 per barrel could sustain cost pressures.

The report noted benchmark 10-year government bond yields had risen around 70 basis points in calendar year 2026, with yields likely to remain elevated until geopolitical tensions ease and inflationary pressures moderate.

Higher interest rates are expected to support bank margins in the near term, although non-food credit growth could gradually slow towards the end of the current financial year (FY27).

SBI Capital Markets expects FY27 to remain favourable for banks, while bonds could regain investor interest in FY28.

Tata Motors increases takeover offer price for Italian truck maker Iveco to €14.40 per share

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 10

Tata Motors Ltd has raised its takeover offer for Italian truck maker Iveco Group NV by €0.30 per share to €14.40, citing delays in the authorisation process.

In 2025, Tata Motors announced plans to acquire Iveco, excluding its defence business, for €3.8 billion (nearly Rs 38,240 crore) through TML CV Holdings Pte Ltd.

The commercial vehicle major had earlier offered €14.10 per share, valuing the transaction at €3.82 billion.

It launched an all-cash voluntary tender offer for all outstanding Iveco common shares in September.

The acceptance period runs from September 7 to October 26, 2026, while Iveco shareholders are scheduled to vote on related resolutions at an extraordinary general meeting on October 16.

Iveco's board unanimously backed the deal and recommended that shareholders tender their shares and vote in favour of the earlier offer.

In an exchange filing on Friday night, Tata Motors said the previous offer represented a full and fair valuation of Iveco but the price was being increased because the authorisation process was taking longer than expected.

The revised offer represents a 33.47 per cent premium over Iveco's share price on July 17, 2025, the last trading day before reports of a potential acquisition emerged. It also represents a 6.77 per cent premium over the July 29, 2025, share price, before the acquisition announcement.

If all 271.2 million shares are tendered, the transaction will be valued at €3.91 billion.

Tata Motors will fund the additional payout through an €85 million credit facility from MUFG Bank Ltd, GIFT Branch. The company said the revised offer would not be increased further.

Canada to send 300 biz delegates to India, largest in over 30 years

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Ottawa, October 10

Canada will send nearly 300 business delegates to India next week on its largest trade mission to the country in over 30 years, seeking to expand commercial ties & "more than double bilateral trade" by 2030.

Led by Canadian Minister of International Trade Maninder Sidhu, the delegation will visit Mumbai and Bengaluru from October 12 to 17, according to an official statement on Friday.

"By matching Canadian expertise in sectors like aerospace, agri-food and clean technology with India's growing demand, we will diversify our trade and attract new investment," Sidhu said.

The mission comes as India and Canada are working to conclude negotiations for a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement by the end of this year. The fifth round of negotiations was held in Ottawa from October 5 to 9.

Sidhu met Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on the margins of the G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting in Milwaukee, US on October 1, where they discussed progress in the talks & efforts to deepen bilateral trade and investment ties. The two nations announced the renewed push for a comprehensive trade agreement during Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney's visit to India in March, setting a target of raising two-way trade to CAD 70 billion (around Rs. 4.75 lakh crore) by 2030.

'India needs to strengthen pathway between patent filing, commercialisation'

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 10

India needs to strengthen the pathway from research and patent protection to commercialisation and value creation, as patent filings alone do not guarantee market success or economic impact, experts said.

Sacha Wunsch-Vincent of the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) said research and development must be strengthened to generate intellectual property, which needs to be commercialised, licensed and taken to market.

He called for stronger university-industry linkages, support for grassroots and student innovation, an open research system, financing for deep-science ventures and greater depth in high-tech manufacturing.

Shivani Singh of the Advanced Study Institute of Asia said patent filing or registration does not establish commercialisation, international competitiveness or economic impact.

Cybersecurity key to economic resilience: WEF report

It also highlighted vulnerabilities in under-resourced economies & organisations

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 10



CLOSER LOOK

- WEF survey found that 42% of respondents recognised cybersecurity's measurable impact on economic output and markets
- WEF urged organisations to treat cybersecurity spending as productive capital rather than merely a defensive cost

Decision-makers must adopt a common framework to translate digital risks into measurable economic outcomes, as cybersecurity has become critical to economic resilience, a WEF report said.

Digital systems underpin payments, supply chains, production and public services, making systemic failures capable of disrupting essential services across borders and affecting national economic performance. The Survey on Cyber Language and Executive Decision-Making, conducted in April 2026, found that 42 per cent of respondents recognised cybersecurity's measurable impact on economic output and markets, but only 9 per cent said their organisations viewed it as an economic stabiliser. More than half said investments were driven by crises rather than demonstrated financial returns.

The WEF's Global Future Council on Cybersecurity called for boards, governments, investors and technical leaders to link cyber risks with resilience, business continuity, trust and economic stability. It urged organisations to treat cybersecurity spending as productive capital rather than merely a defensive cost.

The report identified six metrics to assess cyber preparedness: service continuity, recovery credibility, dependency concentration, tail-loss exposure, value preserved and the impact of cyber posture on the cost of capital. These would help boards, finance ministries and investors incorporate cyber risks into economic and investment decisions.

It also highlighted vulnerabilities in under-resourced economies and organisations, which face significant exposure but have limited capacity to absorb systemic shocks. The report recommended sustainable financing through philanthropy, corporate giving, development finance and pooled funding to strengthen foundational capabilities.

The priority for 2027 is to convert institutional awareness into coordinated public- and private-sector leadership to protect the broader digital economy.

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Delhi will not be held hostage: CM

Gupta accuses Rahul, Kejriwal of putting politics above public interest

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 10

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Saturday accused Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal of putting political interests above public convenience, alleging that their actions could turn the national capital into a battleground and disrupt the daily lives of residents.

In a statement, Gupta criticised the Opposition leaders over a proposed protest, questioning the impact of political demonstrations on commuters, daily-wage workers and patients travelling to hospitals.

"Who will take responsibility for the troubles of employees heading to work, labourers earning a daily wage to support their families, and patients trying to reach hospitals?" she asked, adding that political ambitions should not come at the cost of the livelihoods, safety and peace of millions of families in Delhi.

The Chief Minister accused the opposition of being unable to accept the BJP's electoral success, arguing that Delhi had voted for development and that Prime Minister Narendra Modi's third consecutive term reflected public support for his leadership.

"Parties mired in dynastic politics and opportunism simply cannot digest this public backing," she said.

Targeting Kejriwal, Gupta accused him of attempting to disturb peace and security in the capital for political gains. She also referred to the opposition leaders' alleged association with CJP, describing the group as their "B-team", and accused them of seeking to create disorder under the guise of democratic protest.

The remarks came amid political tensions over the proposed demonstration, with the Chief Minister focusing on the potential inconvenience to residents and the need to maintain public order.

"Let it be known: Delhi will not be held hostage," Gupta said, warning that attempts to spread what she termed anarchy and challenge the people's mandate would be opposed.

She maintained that public demonstrations should not disrupt essential activities or compromise the safety of residents. Her statement, however, did not specify the expected scale of traffic disruption or provide details of arrangements being made to manage the proposed protest.

The comments underline the growing political confrontation between the BJP and opposition parties in Delhi, with public inconvenience and the right to protest emerging as competing points of contention.


FILE PIC

CLOSER LOOK

- Chief Minister Gupta criticised the Oppn leaders over a proposed protest, questioning the impact of political demonstrations on commuters, daily-wage workers and patients travelling to hospitals
- The Chief Minister accused the opposition of being unable to accept the BJP's electoral success

'Women safety measures': Delhi deploys over 2940 bus marshals

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has deployed 2,947 bus marshals in Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses and is operating 56 special buses for women as part of its safety measures, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Saturday.

Of the 56 special buses, 15 operate during the evening shift, with armed women police personnel deployed on them after 5 pm, she said.

All buses have been connected to the Bus Management System (BMS), with panic alarms, live CCTV feeds and GPS monitored round the clock through a control centre, Gupta said in a statement. The Department of Women and Child Development will soon introduce additional accommodation facilities for working women in Vishwas Nagar and Rohini, she added.

"The Delhi government is strengthening systems to ensure that women receive prompt assistance during a crisis, working women have access to essential facilities and every child gets the opportunity to learn, progress and develop their abilities in a safe environment," she said.

She said Child Welfare Committees and Juvenile Justice Boards are functioning as statutory bodies to protect children's rights. Sub-Divisional Magistrates have been designated as Child Marriage Prohibition Officers to prevent child marriages, while around 1.5 lakh CCTV cameras are available in schools to improve children's safety and confidence, she said.

Self-defence training is being provided in 1,397 schools under the Rani Lakshmibai Self-Defence Training Programme, the Chief Minister added.

Highlighting the measures to improve road safety and infrastructure, Gupta said 96,000 streetlights have been installed on roads under the Public Works Department (PWD), including 45,000 high-pressure sodium vapour (HPSV) lights and 51,000 LED lights.

A total of 2,53,983 CCTV cameras under the department are operational, she said. Citizens can register complaints through the toll-free number 1908 and the PWD Seva Porta.

She also highlighted the multi-layered safety network, which includes the Women's Helpline 181, DTC services and measures focused on child protection.

Dilli Haat 'becomes' Jantar Mantar amid security curbs

ANAMTA FATIMA/PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, October 10



Security and barricades in central Delhi prevented protesters from reaching Jantar Mantar on Saturday, as the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP), student groups and Left organisations sought the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and rollback of the Special Intensive Revision.

Restrictions around Connaught Place, Janpath and Parliament Street also disrupted journalists' movement, with reporters saying they were denied passage despite showing media identity cards.

Protest shifts from Jantar Mantar

After police denied permission for the demonstration, All India Students' Association (AISA) national president Neha Bora and other activists mobilised elsewhere. Bora, along with psephologist Yogendra Yadav, lawyer Prashant Bhushan and CPI(ML) Liberation general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya, led a gathering from Jor Bagh towards Dilli Haat-INA.

Bora later said on social media, "I am in detention, but the movement is not," and urged supporters to gather near Safdarjung Flyover and Sri Aurobindo Marg. CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke and spokespersons Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were intercepted and detained after arriving.

Danish, AISA joint secretary, alleged police lathi-charged students, misbehaved with women protesters and dragged them by their hair before detaining them. He claimed officers did not tell detainees where they were being taken. The allegations were not independently verified.

Students take shelter at Bangla Sahib

Around 30 to 50 protesters took shelter inside Bangla Sahib as police restricted movement near Jantar Mantar. Some alleged they had been taken 20 to 50 kilometres away and released, making it difficult to regroup.

"We are here to protest, not to get detained," said Sarika, a research scholar who declined to identify her institution, citing fears of repercussions. She alleged police and CRPF personnel chased protesters towards the gurdwara and said some people outside were dragged away. Sarika criticised organisers for not keeping participants informed about alternatives. "Dialogue is the most important part of democracy," she said.

Jitender Kumar (24), from Uttar Pradesh, questioned the deployment of police against demonstrators. Sumit, from Rohtak, alleged protesters were moved away to prevent them from assembling. Nikhil, a government employee, sought accountability over alleged irregularities in elections.

Journalists stopped despite ID cards

Reporters from several news organisations said they were unable to reach Connaught Place, Jantar Mantar and Parliament Street despite carrying media identification. A journalist with Informist Media said police stopped her while she was travelling from Mandi House towards Connaught Place and directed her towards India Gate.

A Delhi Police head constable reportedly said the ID card shown was not valid for passage. A senior police official said the government's guidelines should have been stricter, noting that not every journalist carried a Press Information Bureau card. This raised questions about implementation of government guidelines asking journalists to carry valid identification. Delhi Police had not commented on the allegations at the time of reporting.

'Tahir Hussain allowed mob to use his building to pelt stones'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 10

A Delhi court on Saturday held that expelled AAP leader Tahir Hussain had allowed a mob to use his building as a vantage point to pelt stones at people and properties during the February 2020 northeast Delhi riots, convicting him of abetment to rioting.

This is the second conviction of Hussain in a case related to the riots. On July 31, a Delhi court sentenced the former AAP councillor and four co-convicts to life imprisonment for the murder of Intelligence Bureau officer Ankit Sharma.

Additional Sessions Judge Parveen Singh convicted Hussain under Section 147 (rioting) read with Section 109 (abetment) of the Indian Penal Code (IPC) in the case registered at Dayalpur police station.

He was acquitted of the more serious charges, including Sections 148 (rioting while armed with deadly weapon), 380 (Stealing from a residential house), 427 (mischief causing damage), 435, 436 (mischief by fire or explosive) and 450 (trespass to commit offence punishable with life imprisonment) of the IPC, read with Section 109.

In its 53-page judgment, the court said the prosecution had proved beyond reasonable doubt that on February 24, 2020, between 2 pm and 3 pm, a mob gathered on the terrace of Hussain's house on Main Karawal Nagar Road and used the building's height to pelt stones at passers-by and nearby properties.

The court relied on the testimonies of four public witnesses.

RSS 'supporters' clash with CJP 'protesters'

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 10

Some alleged Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) supporters reportedly raised slogans against the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and clashed with demonstrators, who gathered in the national capital on Saturday to protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The confrontation unfolded amid heightened security in the city over the CJP's proposed protest. The alleged RSS supporters were reportedly seen "opposing" the protesters' demands and "creating a disturbance" at the site.

The incident raised questions over the police response, with protesters facing detention while the group confronting them was accused of being allowed access to the protest area.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi criticised the police action and accused the BJP of using people associated with it to target protesters.

"They are silencing voices as you saw in Delhi. The entire city was shut down; the internet was shut down. Police were beating students. BJP released their own 'goondas' who were beating and thrashing students," he said.

The demonstration took place under heavy security arrangements in parts of central Delhi. However, the identities of the men involved in targeting protesters, their organisational affiliations and police action against them could not be independently confirmed.

Cops 'ignored' Press ID cards, used 'batons', claim journalists

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, September 11

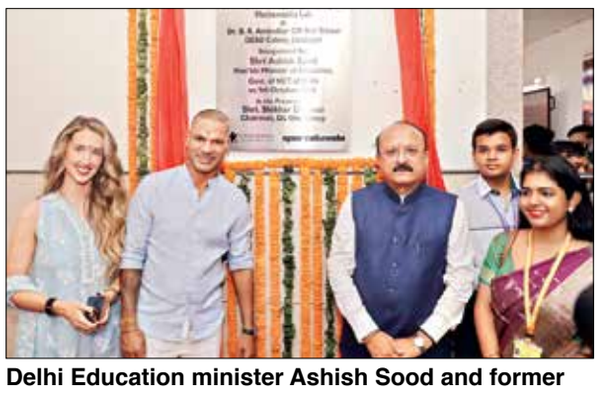
Two independent journalists have alleged that Delhi Police personnel lathi-charged them near New Delhi Police Station while they were questioning members of the opposing CJP group during a protest on Saturday.

The journalists claimed that police continued using force even after they showed their press identity cards, questioning the need for such action against them.

They also alleged that the personnel involved were not wearing name badges, making identification difficult, and that the officer concerned later denied the incident.

Janakpuri school gets STEM lab

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 10


Delhi Education minister Ashish Sood and former cricketer Shikhar Dhawan inaugurate a STEM laboratory at CM Shri School in Janakpuri

Delhi Education minister Ashish Sood and former Indian cricketer Shikhar Dhawan on Saturday inaugurated a Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) laboratory at CM Shri School in Janakpuri, aimed at giving students access to practical, technology-based learning.

The facility has been established under the Shikhar Dhawan Foundation's STEM Shiksha initiative, with corporate social responsibility (CSR) support from Sportskeeda. The inauguration was held under the Delhi government's Seva Sankalp Abhiyan.

The laboratory marks the expansion of the foundation's Digital Shiksha programme, which focuses on improving access to technology-enabled education in government schools.

Sood said the initiative would help students move beyond conventional classroom learning and prepare for future opportunities.

"STEM Labs are an important step in this direction, enabling students to move beyond textbook learning and learn through experience, exploration and experimentation," he said.

Dhawan, chairperson of Da One Group and founder of the Shikhar Dhawan Foundation, said the initiative aimed to make technology-based education accessible to more students.

He also expressed gratitude to the Delhi government for supporting the STEM Shiksha programme.

DELHI POLICE
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

TRAFFIC POLICE DELHI

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BETTER ROADS STRONGER CONNECTIVITY

From village roads to industrial corridors, Uttar Pradesh is building a stronger, wider and better-connected network





A road is more than a stretch of asphalt. It is a link to a school, a market, a hospital, a workplace and, increasingly, to new centres of industry and investment. In Uttar Pradesh, road infrastructure is being developed with this larger purpose in mind. Under the vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, the state's road development focus is extending from rural connectivity and strengthening existing routes to bridges, industrial corridors, logistics parks, airports and border routes. The emphasis is on creating infrastructure that does not merely connect places, but connects people with opportunity.

Uttar Pradesh's road infrastructure at a glance

- **37,058 km** — New roads constructed
- **30,348 km** — Roads widened & strengthened
- **2.94 lakh km** — Road renewal undertaken
- **1,995** — Bridges constructed since 2017
- **170** — Railway Over Bridges completed
- **17 districts** — Airport terminals connected

Building a road network at scale



37,058 km of new roads constructed since April 2017

- Another 30,348 km of roads have been widened and strengthened under various PWD schemes.
- Around 37,018 km of rural roads have been constructed during the current government's tenure.
- The network now reaches villages, towns, district headquarters, industrial areas and other key destinations.

Connecting the last mile

Taking roads closer to every community

- Roads closer to every community
- Two-lane connectivity has been taken up for 38 tehsil headquarters, covering 293 km, with 37 works completed.
- Road works covering 1,438 km have been taken up for 189 block headquarters, with 170 works completed.
- Of the 10,610 unconnected revenue villages and habitations identified on the basis of the 2011 Census, sanctioned works have connected 6,216 habitations.
- Rural connectivity is being strengthened through schemes including the Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyay Yojana and Mukhyamantri Gram Yojana.

BRIDGES THAT REMOVE BOTTLENECKS

Because connectivity is complete only when the road stays connected

376 long bridges, including flyovers, have been completed with approach roads since 2017-18.

89 long-pending bridges have been completed.

170 Railway Over Bridges have been completed with approach roads.

1,466 minor bridges have also been completed with approach roads.

A major four-lane Ganga bridge in Prayagraj has been approved at a cost of **₹952.93** crore.



CONNECTING AIRPORTS, BORDERS AND STATES

Uttar Pradesh's road infrastructure is also strengthening access to strategic gateways.

Airport terminals in **17 districts** have been connected through two-lane roads.

Work is underway on **158** international and interstate routes covering **2,877 km,** with **₹4,330.35** crore sanctioned.

129 routes have been completed.

12 Indo-Nepal Border Road works covering **235 km** are being executed at a sanctioned cost of **₹1,039 crore,** with around **230 km** physically progressed.

Rural Roads, Bigger Reach, Better Opportunities



Under ongoing rural road programmes, the scale of work continues to expand:

- 1,659 works covering 4,017.96 km have been sanctioned for 2026-27 under Mukhyamantri Gram Yojana, with an allocation of ₹2,604.31 crore.
- Since 2023-24, 3,851 Sugar Mill Road works covering 4,010.47 km have been taken up at a cost of ₹2,113.84 crore.
- Under PMGSY-III, 11,990.757 km of the 12,273.64 km sanctioned under the 2021-22 batches had been completed by September 2026.

Roads designed for a growing economy

Connecting industry, logistics & markets

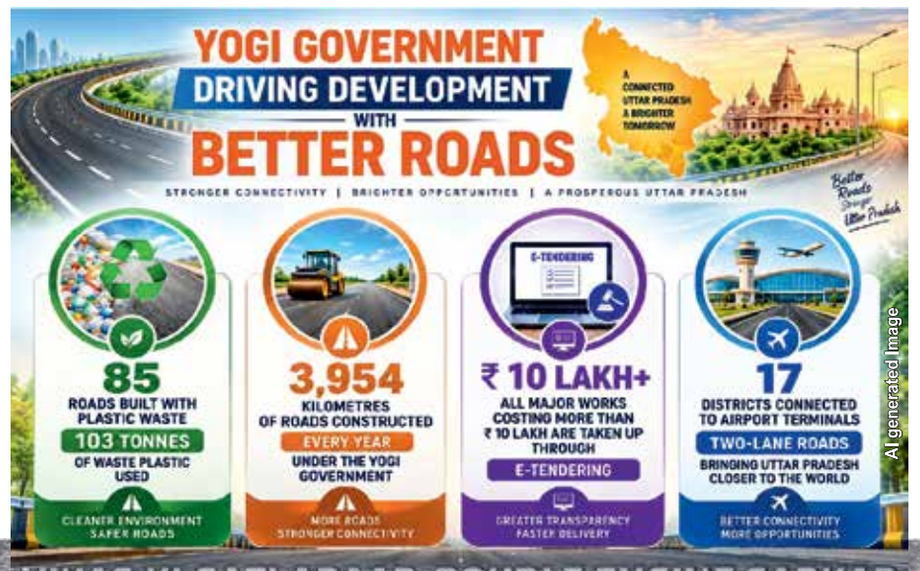
The road network is increasingly being planned around the needs of Uttar Pradesh's expanding industrial economy.

- 75 industrial logistics connectivity works have been approved.
- Together, these cover 343.689 km, with ₹2,809.81 crore sanctioned.
- The objective is to provide last-mile two-lane and four-lane connectivity to industrial and logistics parks.
- Six corridors have been identified under the North-South Corridor initiative, improving connectivity from the Nepal-border region through Uttar Pradesh towards Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana.

Safer roads, smarter construction

Infrastructure growth is being accompanied by a stronger focus on safety, sustainability and technology.

- 1,871 road safety works have been planned for 2026-27 under the Zero Fatality District approach, involving ₹359.30 crore.
- Safety audits have been conducted by institutions including IIT Delhi, IIT BHU and CRRI.
- 85 plastic roads covering 109.53 km have been completed, using around 103 tonnes of waste plastic.
- Modern construction technologies can reduce material consumption and costs by around 20-25%.



Building better roads, ensuring better service

The infrastructure effort extends beyond construction

- Since April 2017, PWD has undertaken 2,94,805 km of road renewal.
- All PWD works costing more than ₹10 lakh are taken up through e-tendering.
- Digital systems such as Prahari, Chanakya and Vishwakarma support tendering, budgeting, measurement, billing and allocation.
- Toll-free and WhatsApp channels provide avenues for public feedback and complaints.

ADVERTORIAL

CALLS CJP PROTEST A FLOP SHOW

Country will be run from Parliament, not streets: BJP

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 10

The CJP protest meant to take the city "hostage" turned out to be a "flop show", the BJP said on Saturday, as it accused Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal of spreading anarchy in cahoots with foreign powers while likening them to Mir Jafar.

It was a victory of democracy over "mob rule", BJP leader Sambit Patra said, as over 7,000 people, including several politicians, were detained to prevent them from taking part in a protest at Jantar Mantar called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

The ruling party described the CJP as the "B-Team" of Gandhi and Kejriwal.

Senior BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad, on the other hand, alleged that the CJP had called the protest for "shadow boxing" for the Aam Aadmi Party, but Indian democracy destroyed their "quest for anarchy".

At a separate press conference at the BJP headquarters, Prasad accused the Congress and its allies, as well as AAP, of trying to "weaponise" street protests following defeat in various elections.



Police personnel detain a woman activist during a demonstration call by the CJP demanding the resignation of CEC, in New Delhi, Saturday PTI

CLOSER LOOK

- The ruling party described the CJP as the "B-Team" of Gandhi and Kejriwal
- Nabin also alleged that Gandhi, Kejriwal and the CJP are resorting to create anarchy

"These defeated and frustrated parties have been harassing people of Delhi for the last three-four days. They are weaponising the street protest, but people have foiled their conspiracy. The dignity of democracy has destroyed the chronic anarchy which the Opposition is trying to foment," Prasad said.

"The country will be run from Parliament, not the streets," he added.

BJP president Nitin Nabin accused the two leaders and the CJP of attempting to destabilise the country with the backing of foreign forces, and asserted that the government will deal sternly with their "ill intentions", while the party workers will foil their design on the ground.

Nabin also alleged that Gandhi, Kejriwal and the CJP are resorting to create anarchy because they "cannot digest the country's progress" under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership.

The ruling party had back-to-back press conferences on Saturday and deployed its senior leaders for the counter-offensive.

Addressing a press conference at the party headquarters here, Patra called Gandhi a "nalayak" leader, condemning his Friday remarks that President Droupadi Murmu did not deny the INDIA Bloc's "vote chori" allegation at a meeting.

PM-HM duo rattled by peaceful protest of youth; RIP democracy: Congress

'Suspension of SIR is essential to restore public faith in election system'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 10

The Congress on Saturday claimed that the "PM-HM duo is extremely nervous and rattled" by a peaceful protest of youth, and said the current regime has "officially waged war against its own people".

The Opposition party also said the suspension of the SIR that has already disenfranchised nearly 14 crore Indians is essential to restore public faith and trust in the election system.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh said the nation's capital has been turned into a fortress and armed security personnel are all over the place.



A demonstrator holds placards during a protest organised by the CJP, in New Delhi, Saturday PTI

"The PM-HM (Narendra Modi-Amit Shah) duo is extremely nervous and rattled by a peaceful protest by youth deeply concerned with the planned stealing of their Constitutional right to vote guaranteed by Article 326," Ramesh said on X.

There is incontrovertible evidence that Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar faithfully executed the orders given to him by the "destructive duo" when he was appointed, he alleged.

In December 2023, a law giving him lifelong immunity was bulldozed through Parliament when 145 Opposition MPs had been suspended, Ramesh said.

JAIRAM RAMESH SAID THE NATION'S CAPITAL HAS BEEN TURNED INTO A FORTRESS

"The resignation of the CEC, who has lied to the Supreme Court itself, has become a moral imperative. But it is only the first step to reclaim the very foundations of our democracy, which is so very essential for fulfilling the hopes and aspirations of all people, especially the youth," the Congress leader said.

Haryana Cabinet approves several key welfare decisions

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 10

The Haryana Cabinet on Saturday took several decisions like bringing HARTRON under CRID, ensuring expansion of HarHith stores and enhancing financial ceiling under Haryana Media Personnel Welfare Fund Administration Scheme.

Among key decisions were the continuation of the recommendations of the 6th State Finance Commission for the devolution of funds to rural and urban local bodies from the financial year 2026-27 until the recommendations of the next State Finance Commission become available.

The decision has been taken as the 7th State Finance Commission has not yet submitted its report to the state government.

Accordingly, as per the established precedent, the approved recommendations of the 6th State Finance Commission will continue to serve as the basis for the distribution of funds to local bodies during this period.

It also approved key amendments to the DeenDayalLado Lakshmi Yojana to extend the benefits of the scheme to more eligible women, simplify its implementation and strengthen the delivery of financial assistance.

Protest against CEC: Sisodia, Cheema detained

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 10

Key AAP leaders, including Manish Sisodia and Punjab Finance minister Harpal Singh Cheema were detained by Chandigarh Police on Saturday.

They were taken into preventive custody to control the law and order situation at the protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the revision of electoral rolls.

DELHI POLICE
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

TRAFFIC ADVISORY

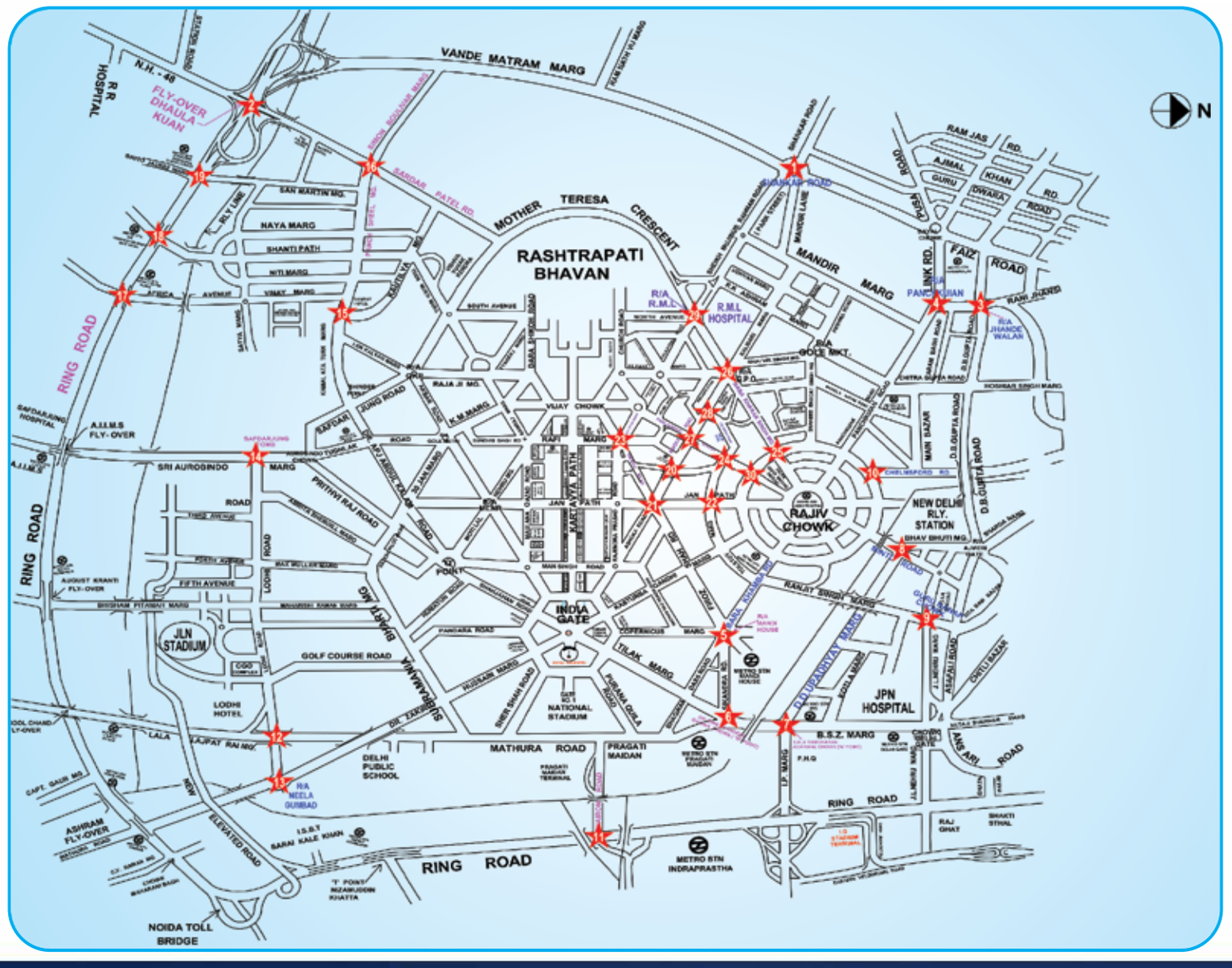
IN VIEW OF LAW AND ORDER SITUATION IN DELHI ON 11.10.2026

TRAFFIC POLICE DELHI

Diversions will be enforced starting from 06:00 AM on 11.10.2026 depending upon prevailing situation.

General public is informed that movement at following points and surrounding stretches might remain affected:-

1. Round About Shankar Road- Vande Matram 'T' Point towards New Delhi
2. Dhaula Kuan Flyover
3. Round About Jhandewalan
4. Round About Panchkuian
5. Round About Mandi House
6. Dr Dinesh Nandini Dalmia Chowk (W-Point)
7. Ram Charan Aggarwal Chowk (A-Point)
8. Minto Road/Deen Dayal Upadhyay Marg
9. Guru Nanak Chowk
10. Chemsford Road - Outer Circle Connaught Place T-Point
11. Bharion Road- MGM (Ring Road) T-Point
12. Lodhi Road Flyover
13. Round About Neela Gumbad
14. Madarsa T- Point
15. Round About Samrat Hotel
16. Sardar Patel Marg- Panchsheel Marg Crossing
17. Under Bhikaji Kama Place
18. Under Moti Bagh Flyover
19. Ring Road-San Martin Marg T-Point
20. Round About Ashoka Road - Jantar Mantar Road
21. Round About Windsor Palace
22. Tolstoy-Janpath Crossing
23. Round About Rail Bhawan
24. Jai Singh Road - Sansad Marg Crossing
25. Outer Circle Connaught Place -Barakhamba Road T-Point
26. Round About Gol Dak Khana
27. Round About Patel Chowk
28. Jai Singh Road - Ashoka Road T-Point
29. Round About RML Hospital
30. Outer Circle Connaught Place - Sansad Marg T-Point



COMMUTERS ADVISORY & RECOMMENDATIONS:

- Please keep extra travel time in hand if heading towards railway stations, ISBTs, or the airport via New Delhi and Central Delhi.
- Commuters are requested not to undertake non essential travel.
- Traffic management measures are dynamic and will be relaxed or regulated based on real-time ground assessment.

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DP/9920/2026

ABOARD FLYDUBAI FLIGHT

NIA to probe mid-air attack on Captain Smit Machchhar

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 10

Anti-terror agency NIA has registered a case to probe and unearth the larger conspiracy behind last month's mid-air attack on Captain Smit Machchhar inside the cockpit of an Israel-bound flydubai flight, officials said on Saturday.

It was reported that on September 30, 2026, the Omani first officer of flydubai flight no 1073 stabbed the Indian pilot, Captain Machchhar, mid-air "in an apparent attempt to hijack or cause it to crash", according to the First Information Report (FIR) filed by the National Investigation Agency (NIA) on October 9. The FIR mentions the "Omani first officer" as the accused.

The NIA has invoked Section 3 (hijacking) of the Anti Hijacking Act, 2016 and Section 16 read with Section 15(1)(a) of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967, officials said.

Section 16 of UAPA entails punishment for terrorist act.

The Section 15(1)(a) details punishment for terrorist activities for "whoever does any act with intent to threaten or likely to threaten the unity, integrity, security, (economic security) or sovereignty of India or with intent to strike terror or likely to strike terror in the people or any section of the people in India or in any foreign country, (a) by using bombs, dynamite or other explosive substances or inflammable substances or firearms or other lethal weapons or poisonous or noxious gases or other chemicals or by any other substances (whether biological radioactive, nuclear or otherwise) of a hazardous nature or by any other means of whatever nature..." Captain Machchhar sustained critical injuries after he was stabbed by the Omani co-pilot inside the cockpit of the flydubai flight heading from Dubai to Tel Aviv. The incident occurred in the "Saudi airspace while flying near the Jordan-Saudi Arabia border".

The case was filed on the direction of the Home Ministry, considering the gravity of the offence and the need to unearth the larger conspiracy, the officials said.

"The Central government has received information that flydubai flight no 1073, which was being piloted by Indian national pilot Captain Smit Machchhar and an Omani first officer, departed from Dubai on September 30, 2026 at 7.05 am (GST) with 174 passengers...," the FIR states. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

From page 1

Capital under

detained leaders claimed that they were driven around in police vehicles for hours.

CPI (M) general secretary M A Baby, veteran Left leader Brinda Karat, CPI(ML) Liberation general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya, activist Yogendra Yadav, lawyer Prashant Bhushan and All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha Bora were also detained.

Gandhi, who was in Chennai for his Chhatron Ki Goonj event, also said the "core characteristic" of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the RSS is "cowardice".

The Congress, which has been holding protests demanding the resignation of the CEC over alleged vote theft, however, maintained its distance from the CJP protest.

In a statement, the CPI(M) said the entire might of the state was brought upon the protesters with massive security deployment, barricading of roads alongwith severe restrictions on movement and communication. "All these constitute a blatant assault on democratic rights to protest peacefully and constitutional freedoms and is a blatant display of authoritarianism,'' it said.

The party said that the government's response exposes its fear of popular mobilisation and its determination to suppress dissent rather than answer serious questions about the SIR process. ``The right to vote is fundamental to democracy and cannot be undermined through opaque procedures or arbitrary exclusions,'' it said.

Dipke and two CJP leaders, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka, were detained by Delhi Police from inside the aircraft as soon as their flight from Mumbai landed in at IGI airport here.

In a video shared by the CJP, Dipke could be heard telling police officers who entered the aircraft, "We are here to be arrested, come and arrest us." Before the detention, police personnel told the CJP leaders that they did not have permission to hold their protest at Jantar Mantar.

Dipke said CJP leaders were being detained as if they were criminals. He said that even former prime minister Indira Gandhi did not do this, adding that it amounted to dictatorship.

Rathee, who lives abroad and had come to join the CJP protest against CEC Kumar, was detained by police from his residence in Gurugram's Sector 56.

In the afternoon, scores of protesters hurled stones at security personnel near Akashwani Bhawan on Imtiaz Ali Marg after jumping barricades, injuring two police personnel. The protesters were quickly detained by security personnel.

New Delhi virtually turned khaki with the deployment of over 30,000 police and paramilitary personnel ahead of the CJP protest. Waves of barricades lining the streets, the closure of 45 metro stations and intensive checks at the city's border points, railway stations, bus terminals, hotels and other sensitive locations left the capital gridlocked.

More than 7,000 protesters were detained today across Delhi, including more than 2,000 in New Delhi area, police sources said.

In a pre-recorded video message released soon after his detention, CJP leader Dipke said the organisation's in-charge, Ajinkya Shinde, would lead its protest at Jantar Mantar. The CJP asserted that the protest would continue nationwide, with or without its leaders.

Police informed Dipke about the death of his grandmother in Maharashtra and offered possible facilitation for his journey to his hometown on humanitarian grounds. Dipke's paternal grandmother, Savitribai Shankarrao Dipke, 85, died at her home in Santuk Pimpri village in Maharashtra's Hingoli district around 11.30 am on Saturday following a prolonged illness, family sources said.

Activist Sonam Wangchuk said he would consider launching a peaceful protest, including a hunger strike or a march in Leh or Delhi, if the detainees were not released within 24 hours. Wangchuk had joined the earlier 36-day agitation of the CJP at Jantar Mantar on the NEET paper leak issue that had ended on July 25.

Hitting out at the Opposition, the BJP said that the protest meant to take the city "hostage" turned out to be a "flop show", accusing Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi of spreading anarchy in cahoots with foreign powers.

BJP leader and MP Ravi Shankar Prasad said India was not a banana republic, adding ``we are not opposed to protests, but you have weaponised street protests because of your electoral defeat.'' His comments were directed aimed at the Congress.

A large number of police personnel detained groups of protesters from several places, including Hanuman Temple, Akashwani Bhawan, Safdarjung Flyover and Kerala House. Regular announcements were being made by the police at Jantar Mantar, instructing people and mediapersons not to gather in one place.

BJP president Nitin Nabin accused Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, Kejriwal and the CJP of attempting to destabilise the country with the backing of foreign forces.

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta asserted that the capital will not be held hostage and accused Gandhi and Kejriwal of trying to turn the city into a "battleground", in league with their "B-Team" CJP.

Several journalists claimed that they were detained. Reporters alleged that they were detained despite displaying their press identity cards, and that their official phones were seized by police personnel before they were taken to detention buses along with other protesters. Visuals circulating showed journalists displaying their press identity cards from inside the buses.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge lashed out at the Modi government over the detentions by Delhi police, saying it has turned the "mother of democracy" into a "muzzled democracy". The Congress chief alleged that the cowardice of the BJP-RSS is on full display today.

More than 120 companies of Central Armed Police Forces assisted Delhi Police in managing the security situation. Authorities also monitored social media platforms for attempts to mobilise people for the protest. More than 200 content creators were reportedly under the police scrutiny.

CJP's Jantar

the detentions today. This fear of Modi, Shah shows we have won half the fight," said Shinde, who's leading the protest as key members of CJP remain under detention.

"As many people as you detain, we will not go back till Gyanesh Kumar resigns. We will head to Jantar Mantar again at 10 am tomorrow," Shinde said.

He urged people to join the demonstration in large numbers and continue protesting even if stopped by the police.

"Come to Jantar Mantar in large numbers, and protest wherever Delhi Police stops you," he said.

The outfit said civil disobedience and street protests would continue across the country until accountability was fixed over the alleged deletion and manipulation of 13 crore votes.

CJP representatives condemned the detention of party leaders and other protesters during Saturday's demonstrations, alleging that the authorities had imposed an "undeclared Emergency" in the national capital to prevent people from assembling peacefully.

Shinde criticised the heavy security deployment and restrictions, alleging that Delhi had been turned into a "cantonment or fortress".

He claimed that more than 15,000 people, including students, civil society members and political figures, had faced detentions and police action. He also alleged that restrictions on transport services and the deployment of signal jammers were aimed at suppressing peaceful protests.

Nationalist Congress Party spokesperson Anish Gawande said attempts were being made to create a divide between civil society groups and opposition parties participating in protests against the chief election commissioner.

"The protests that have taken place against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar have always featured unity between civil society actors and the opposition," Gawande said.

Citing the detention of former chief ministers, MPs and political workers, he said opposition parties had participated in demonstrations organised by different political groups in Maharashtra and Delhi.

A false divide was being created between opposition parties and civil society actors seeking accountability, he said, adding that the two would continue to work together.

Srijan Bhattacharya of the Students' Federation of India (SFI) said, "We are working with broadest possible unity against dictatorship."

The CJP representatives also criticised restrictions on access to Jantar Mantar, the closure of metro stations, suspension of train services and preventive detentions at transit hubs, alleging that the measures were intended to obstruct peaceful assembly.

The organisers said the campaign for electoral transparency would continue across multiple states until constitutional rights were safeguarded.

"Civil disobedience and street protests will continue relentlessly until jails are filled and the government is held accountable. Democracy is not for sale," the statement said.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Traffic Police issued an advisory warning of possible traffic disruptions in New Delhi and central Delhi on Sunday, October 11, in view of the law-and-order situation.

Diversions may come into effect from 6 am, depending on the prevailing situation, the advisory said.

Several major roads and intersections could be affected, including areas around Jantar Mantar, Sansad Marg, Connaught Place, Mandi House, Rail Bhawan, Patel Chowk, Dhaula Kuan, Lodhi Road and Sardar Patel Marg.

Commuters travelling through New Delhi and central Delhi towards railway stations, inter-state bus terminals and the airport have been advised to allow extra travel time. The police have also requested people to avoid non-essential travel.

Traffic restrictions may be modified depending on real-time ground conditions, the advisory said, asking commuters to follow updates on the Delhi Traffic Police website. MPOST

SC to hold spl

Govind Mohan, Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar and Delhi Metro Rail Corporation chairperson D Thara as respondents.

"This brutal assault on the fundamental rights of the citizens and sheer disregard to the orders of this court amounts to deliberate, intentional attempt on the part of Delhi Metro, Delhi Police and the Union government which must be dealt with an iron hand," the plea, filed through advocate Chand Qureshi, said.

The petition referred to the top court's October 9 order which was passed while hearing a separate plea against the closure of 57 metro stations and cancellation of trains to Delhi in view of the protest.

The protest call was given by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and some student organisations against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission.

While hearing the petition on Friday, a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Bagchi and Mohana had directed the Centre to ensure that there was no "complete prohibition" of the movement of metro and trains coming to Delhi on October 10 due to the protest, saying they cannot bring everything to a halt.

Though law enforcement agencies have the right to take steps to restrict unruly movement, citizens should not be unduly harassed, the top court had said.

Delhi Metro closed 45 stations from 9 pm on Friday till 6 pm on Saturday for security reasons, an advisory had said.

The contempt plea said notwithstanding the solemn judicial mandate and the assurance recorded before the top court, the authorities have "consciously maintained a blanket shutdown across transit corridors, persisted with unwarranted train cancellations, and failed to issue or publicize transparent traffic and transit advisories".

"This deliberate recalcitrance has severely crippled public life across the National Capital Territory, stranding essential travellers, and amounts to an intentional attempt to bypass and undermine the authority and majesty of this court," the plea submitted.

It said the petitioner was directly affected with the "arbitrary closure" of metro stations/gates of metro stations in Delhi.

"The instant contempt petition needs immediate intervention of this court because there is the blatant violations of the orders passed on October 9 by this court, by closing the entry and exit gates of Delhi Metro in-spite of the clear and unambiguous order of this court that only regulatory measures can be taken to regulate the crowd and it can't be a preventive step," the plea said. MPOST

Oct 12: INDIA's

surrounding the Special Intensive Revision of the electoral rolls.

Addressing the media in the national capital, Mamata Banerjee said she would carry on with her agitation for the benefit of the country's citizens. The former chief minister of West Bengal also held a dharna outside the gate of Dwarka North police station following her detention and five other TMC leaders by the Delhi Police.

Reacting strongly to the move of the police, Banerjee raised questions about why they put elected people into a police vehicle and made them sit there for such a long time. "We are not criminals who will be taken into a prison van and made to go for two hours. We are political people," she said, alleging that the government was scared of their protest. Those accompanying Banerjee include TMC Rajya Sabha MPs Derek O'Brien and Dola Sen, along with Lok Sabha MP Pratima Mandal and Rajya Sabha MP Samirul Islam. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Bureaucratic

of 27 civil servants at joint secretary and equivalent levels.

Ravi Shanakar, Chittaranjan Dash, P Manoj Kumar and Abhishek Bhagotia have been appointed as joint secretaries in the Ministry of Home Affairs.

Mohammed Y Safirulla K and Ritu Sharma will be joint secretaries in the Department of Health and Family Welfare.

Varnali Deka, a 2009 batch IAS officer of Assam-Meghalaya cadre, has been appointed as Joint Secretary, National Health Authority.

More Ashish Madhaorao will be Additional Chief Executive Officer (JS level), National Health Authority.

Nikhil Varma has been appointed Additional Director General of Foreign Trade, Delhi; Tanvi Sundriyal as Joint Secretary, Ministry of Corporate Affairs; and Inderjeet Singh as Joint Secretary, Ministry of Culture, the order said.

Senior IAS officer Tamboli Ayyaj Fakirbhai has been named as Executive Director (JS level), Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India; Rajesh Malik as Executive Director, Food Corporation of India; and Navin Agarwal as Joint Secretary, Department of Legal Affairs.

Brijesh Pandey has been appointed Joint Secretary, Department of Capital Development; M Ramachandrudu as Joint Secretary, Ministry of Minority Affairs; and Sonia Pant will be Adviser (JS level), NITI Aayog.

Nitin Kumar has been named as Additional Secretary (JS level), Central Vigilance Commission; C Muruganas as Joint Secretary, Ministry of Road Transport and Highways; Rajneesh Kumar Tomar as CEO, National Highways Logistics Management Ltd; and Nishtha Tiwari as CEO, Development and Welfare Board for Denotified Nomadic and Semi-Nomadic Communities under the Department of Social Justice and Empowerment.

Manisha Trighatia will be Joint Secretary, Department of Urban Development; Avinash Jain will be Joint Secretary, Department of Water Resources, River Development and Ganga Rejuvenation; Pawan Kumar will be Joint Secretary, National River Conservation Directorate; and Anita Shah Akella will be Joint Secretary, National Commission for Women.

In a separate order dated October 9, the ACC has approved a proposal of the Department of Higher Education for premature repatriation of Govind Jaiswal, Joint Secretary, Department of Higher Education, to his parent cadre.

Jaiswal is a 2007 batch IAS officer of the AGMUT (Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Mizoram and Union Territories) cadre.

Oil you need is

to the American and Global Marketplace," Trump said in a post on Truth Social.

He said Russia would supply another 500,000 tonnes of diesel in November, followed by one million tonnes immediately thereafter.

"Additionally, based on the condition of their diesel refineries, Russia will then deliver, within a short period of time, 3,000,000 tonnes of diesel fuel," Trump said.

The announcement comes as the US battles high fuel prices amid the war on Iran, which has become a key issue in the midterm elections on November 3.

Several opinion polls have predicted that it would be tough for the Republican Party to retain control of the US Congress in the midterm elections.

Trump said the US' control of the Strait of Hormuz, along with the proposed Russian diesel supplies, would bring down fuel prices sharply.

"Gifts to Putin will not bring peace or any benefit to the civilised world," Zelenskyy said in a social media post.

"Russia will 'repay' the diesel with further terror and perfidy. Allowing Russia to sell petroleum products is an investment in a war that must be ended, not prolonged," Zelenskyy said.

US House Representative Don Bacon posted on X, "70% of Americans support Ukraine. Propping up Putin's war economy is morally wrong as he uses that money to bomb cities. The President's policies towards Russia and Ukraine are failures. We need moral clarity not moral ambiguity."

US Senator Richard Blumenthal, the co-author of the Russia sanctions act, has slammed Trump's deal with President Putin to buy diesel from Moscow, terming the move as an embarrassment.

Blumenthal, along with late Republican Senator Lindsey Graham, had authored the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, which was passed by both Houses of US Congress with an overwhelming majority on September 16. Trump signed the Act into a law two days later.

It was Blumenthal who had warned China and India to clean up your act and buy oil from elsewhere soon after the US Congress passed the Russia sanctions act on September 16.

"If Trump keeps cutting (illegal) oil deals with Russia, we may just have to start sanctioning ourselves," Congressman Dave Min, a Democrat from California, said.

Musk ups attack

prowess, Reliance Jio Infocomm Chairman Akash Ambani declined to comment on the ongoing debate over satellite communication services, saying the company was focused on delivering value to Indian consumers.

A few hours before he made the post, Musk on X addressed Mukesh Ambani as "Prime Minister Ambani" and accused him of protecting a monopoly. Musk wondered if Ambani would consider allowing his satellite internet service to compete with his entity in the country.

On Friday, Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia asserted that India does not permit monopolies in any sector, and that despite the buzz around one particular company, three players have received satcom licences and can start operations after meeting the security requirements and milestones.

Musk has alleged that powerful business interests are seeking to block his service to preserve their dominance in the Indian market. He said his Starlink was being blocked by certain oligarchs seeking to "maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people."

"Dear Prime Minister Ambani, Please accept my humble apologies for not realising that you are the real boss of India. Naturally, you would prefer to maintain your monopolistic exploitation of the great people of India, but would you nonetheless consider allowing Starlink to compete?" he wrote.

Musk also said many areas of India have no internet access and the absence denies children education and small businesses the opportunity to sell their goods to a global market.

Starlink would change their lives for the better, the technocrat asserted.

Within minutes of that post late Friday evening, Musk wrote another, saying Starlink has proven to be essential in saving lives during natural disasters throughout the world, when all other communication systems failed. "So you would also be helping save men, women and children throughout India," he added.

Scindia has said India doesn't allow monopoly in any sector.

"Let me set the record straight. For us, the Department of Telecommunications, we are technology agnostic... Our job is to be able to provide the bouquet of services to every single customer. It is for the customer to choose in a free market which service he or she prefers, and within that service bouquet, which company's service he or she prefers," the Union minister said at a briefing at the India Mobile Congress here.

Scindia said three entities - Musk's Starlink, Reliance Jio's satellite venture Jio Satcom, Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb - have already secured licences, while Amazon's Project Kuiper has expressed interest and will need to follow the established procedure.

While there is a lot of conversation about one particular company, three have got satcom licences, he said.

"We are very clear on our stand. There are three parties that have got a licence; as and when the government decides the charge system on the revenue basis, that spectrum will be assigned to them, and as and when they individually fulfil the security conditions, they can start operations," the minister said.

TRAI and the telecom department are close to a final decision on pricing regime for satcom spectrum, Scindia added. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Delhi court

The order barred him from using social media or contacting any mediaperson, and from meeting anyone other than family members, relatives and friends.

The prosecution alleged that Imam violated these conditions, pointing to videos on a YouTube channel and on social media platform X. It said a video uploaded by a news channel showed Imam's brother giving an interview while he was present in the same room.

Rejecting the defence's contention that the video was a compilation of separate clips and that Imam was not present in the room, the court said the footage indicated that the clips had been shot in the same place at approximately the same time.

The case pertains to an FIR registered in connection with the 2020 northeast Delhi riots and includes charges under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act and various provisions of the Indian Penal Code.

News at a glance

8 dead after shooting in Erie, Pennsylvania, governor says

ERIE: Eight people were killed Friday in a shooting in Erie, Pennsylvania, police said.

The shooter was also dead, and there was no threat to the public, the city said. Authorities didn't provide more details. "I have not seen anything like this in my 28-plus years," Erie Police Chief Rick Lorah told a local news station. "I'm not sure that the city of Erie has ever seen the loss of life and the devastation that we just witnessed." Governor Josh Shapiro said Saturday he offered his administration's "full support" to Erie Mayor Daria Devlin.

Key TTP commander killed in joint op in northwest Pak

PESHAWAR: A TTP commander was killed in a joint operation by security forces and a local peace committee on Saturday in northwest Pakistan, police said.

According to the police, the operation was conducted based on intelligence inputs regarding the reported presence of militants belonging to the banned terror outfit Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP) in the Bannu district of the restive Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province. The TTP commander was killed in Ghoriwala area of the district, they said.



The sun rises over the Baltic Sea and the lighthouse of Travemuende, Germany, Saturday AP/PTI

Third school attack in less than a week shakes Poland

WARSAW: Police say a third attack at a Polish school in less than a week took place on Saturday, when a 21-year-old woman injured three people inside an educational institution in the capital, Warsaw, police said.

The attacker used a "dangerous object" to attack a 17-year old woman and ended up hurting two other people, aged 17 and 24 respectively, Jakub Filipiak, a spokesman for Warsaw police, told The Associated Press. None of the injuries was life-threatening.

Briefs

Pakistan EC official shot dead

PESHAWAR: A senior official of the Election Commission of Pakistan was shot dead by unidentified gunmen in a suspected targeted killing in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province on Saturday, police said.

ECP Director General Shamshad Akhtar was killed near Girah Baluch in Tank district, which borders South Waziristan.

The assailants fled the scene after the shooting, while Rescue 1122 personnel shifted the body to the District Hospital.

Trump's Medicaid cuts strip refugees

WASHINGTON: New restrictions have stripped Medicaid coverage from certain legal immigrants, including refugees and victims of human trafficking, as part of broader federal changes to the health insurance program that are expected to force millions off their coverage.

The change effective October 1 cut from Medicaid what is estimated to be hundreds of thousands of people who legally immigrated to the US.

UK govt blocks Ireland march

LONDON: The British government has blocked a contentious march from taking place in Northern Ireland after a two-week standoff between groups that support the region's continued union with the UK and those who favour reunification with the Republic of Ireland.

Northern Ireland Secretary of State Chris Bryant intervened Friday to ban the procession along Garvaghy Road in Portadown.

Pak man kills girl

LAHORE: A 24-year-old man shot dead a 19-year-old girl he wanted to marry before taking his own life in Punjab province of Pakistan, police said on Saturday.

The incident took place on Friday in the Murtaza Town area of Pattoki, some 80kms from Lahore, where the suspect, identified as Nauman, opened fire on the girl after learning that her parents had arranged her marriage to another man.

ANGER IN KYIV OVER DIESEL DEAL

Russian attacks kill 20 in Ukraine

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 10

Russian strikes killed at least 20 people in Ukraine's Zaporizhzhia region, Ukrainian officials said Saturday, a day after US President Donald Trump announced a deal to buy Russian diesel that Kyiv warned would help bankroll Moscow's war in Ukraine.

Three children were among those killed when Russian aerial bombs hit residential buildings in Zaporizhzhia, Ukraine's State Emergency Service said Saturday. At least 18 people were wounded.

Missiles also struck Kyiv in a daytime attack Saturday. Mayor Vitalii Klitschko said four people were wounded.

Russia and Ukraine are locked in a long-range aerial war while their armies remain largely deadlocked on the front line, more than 4.5 years since Moscow's full-scale invasion. Ukraine is struggling to counter escalating Russian bombardments that have killed more than 60 people over the past four days.

Trump said Friday he had struck a deal to obtain diesel from Russia, a stunning reversal of years of US pressure on Moscow over its war with Ukraine and an attempt to address high fuel prices ahead of the US midterm elections.



Rescue workers pull a family from the rubble of a residential building destroyed by a Russian airstrike in Zaporizhzhia, Ukraine, Saturday AP/PTI

KEY POINTS

- Three children were among those killed when Russian aerial bombs hit residential buildings in Zaporizhzhia
- Russia and Ukraine are locked in a long-range aerial war while their armies remain largely deadlocked on the front line

"Today, Russia expressed its thanks for the lifting of sanctions on diesel exports by dropping five glide bombs on residential buildings in Zaporizhzhia," Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy wrote Saturday on X.

He said the attacks show Moscow understands "any easing of pressure to mean they can keep fighting, to mean they can keep dropping bombs on cities."

"Russia's choice is war," Zelenskyy said in a later Telegram post, after drone attacks on energy facilities and a ballistic missile attack on Kyiv. He said every additional billion dollars Russia earns from exports would help pay for weapons components, drone upgrades, missile production and the recruitment of mercenaries, and that Moscow would only be ready to stop when its ability to fight diminished.

Moscow received from diesel deal "signals that it is apparently permissible to continue attacking. And this needs to be corrected," he said, urging the US, Europe and other partners to limit Russia's capacity to wage war.

Zelenskyy said Ukraine was coordinating steps to counter the extra revenue Russia will receive, and that he had spoken to French President Emmanuel Macron about shoring up air defences, warning of an increased risk of further missile strikes in the coming days.

Official: Missile strikes passenger terminal at Riyadh airport

'Many people were wounded'

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cairo, October 10

THE OFFICIALS SPOKE ON CONDITION OF ANONYMITY BECAUSE THEY WEREN'T AUTHORISED TO SPEAK TO THE MEDIA

The airport in the Saudi Arabian capital, Riyadh, was attacked again on Saturday and evacuated, two regional officials said, two days after three Saudi citizens including a pilot were killed as the kingdom faces an extraordinary series of assaults in the new front in the Iran war.

A missile struck a passenger terminal and many people were wounded, one of the officials said. They spoke on condition of anonymity because they weren't authorised to speak to the media. Ambulances were seen rushing toward the airport.

Flights to Riyadh diverted elsewhere, the Flightradar24 tracker said, almost four hours after the last flight landed at 2:05 pm Kuwait Airways said it was cancelling flights because the airport had closed. Canada's embassy advised citizens to avoid all travel to the airport, noting "ongoing military activity."

King Khalid International Airport has been targeted multiple times in the week since a Saudi-led coalition launched a major military offensive against Iran-backed Houthi rebels in neighbouring Yemen. The Houthis claimed responsibility for the earlier attacks, including one Wednesday that killed a Sudanese national.

There was no immediate Houthi statement Saturday. The Saudi government-run Centre for International Communication, which oversees foreign media in the kingdom, didn't immediately respond to a request for comment.

A Riyadh resident, Ahmed Sayed, told The Associated Press he heard at least two loud explosions that rocked the capital.

The airport issued a terse alert telling passengers to check their flight status with airlines before heading to the airport. At least 225 flights at the airport had been cancelled over the past 24 hours, according to flight-tracking site FlightAware.

Fighting in Yemen between the Houthis and Saudi-backed Yemeni government forces has escalated, with the Saudi-led coalition providing air support for government forces in an attempt to reverse recent Houthi gains along the Red Sea.

Pak: 10 terrorists killed in security operation

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Karachi, October 10

Ten terrorists belonging to a banned separatist outfit were killed in an intelligence-based operation in Pakistan's Balochistan province on Saturday, officials said.

Shahid Rind, adviser to the Balochistan chief minister on information, said the terrorists were killed in the Rara Sham area of Barkhan district following a heavy exchange of fire, in which three Counter Terrorism Department (CTD) personnel were also injured.

"The CTD team also recovered a large cache of arms, ammunition and explosives from the hideout," he said.

Rind said the operation was part of an ongoing campaign against insurgent groups and the outlawed Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan in Balochistan.

Dozens of suspected militants have been killed in intelligence-based operations since early September, according to Pakistani authorities.

Spain's slow response to the crisis in Ceuta leaves teen migrants on streets

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Ceuta, October 10

Hundreds of teenage migrants lined up outside a church in Ceuta in early October, hoping Spain's visiting minister of youth would bring them some good news: passage to continental Europe or at least a spot in a shelter.

For two months, they had slept on cardboard sheets and ripped sofas in squalid tent camps, or on the streets of the Spanish city in North Africa that juts into the Mediterranean like a thumb. On clear days, southern Spain is visible on the horizon.

Among them was a 17-year-old aspiring model from northern Morocco. In late July, he crossed into Ceuta with around 80,000 others in what would become Spain's deadliest border crisis.

"Pray for me!" he told an Associated Press reporter. But instead, the teens were led down a steep hill to a soccer field so as not to overwhelm the minister. Within hours, many were back on the streets and hillsides.

Another setback for the young migrants, the scene also illustrated the Spanish government's slow, often improvised response to the migration crisis in the territory.

Thousands of minors reached Ceuta alone and, under Spanish law, are entitled to shelter, healthcare and education.

"I was expecting a really easy experience," said the 17-year-old, who did not want his name used because he is alone in Ceuta and fears for his safety. "I was expecting two to three weeks of this."

Open-air, makeshift camps with adults and children have festered on beaches, at warehouses and on hillsides since tens of thousands of people swam or climbed around a breakwater that separates Morocco from Ceuta in July. About 140 people died trying to cross.

Drone strike in Sudan kills 40 people

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, October 10

A drone strike in Sudan killed dozens of people, including children, said a rights group.

Meanwhile, attacks on the Riyadh international airport in Saudi Arabia earlier this week damaged three aircraft, officials said. Lebanon also welcomed the lifting of a decades-long flight ban with the United States. Here is the latest news from the Middle East on Saturday. Read our full coverage here.

Drone strike kills at least 40 people in Sudan, rights group says

A drone strike killed at least 40 people, including children, in Sudan along the border with Ethiopia, according to Emergency Lawyers, a group that tracks the war.

It said the Rapid Support Forces, a paramilitary group that has been battling Sudan's military since 2023, was responsible for Friday's strike in the Abu Shandi area in Sudan's Blue Nile province. The UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs said it was appalled by the strike.

The conflict has killed at least 150,000 people, according to conflict monitor ACLED, though aid groups say the real number is likely higher.

A YEAR LATER, PROGRESS HAS STALLED

US-brokered ceasefire was supposed to end war in Gaza

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, October 10

It's been a year since a ceasefire deal brokered by US President Donald Trump and Arab allies promised to end the war in Gaza, and Israel is still launching deadly strikes on the devastated territory.

The agreement halted major military operations, freed all remaining hostages and increased humanitarian access. But it has failed to deliver on promises of a new Palestinian administration aided by international forces, the disarmament of Hamas and an end to Israel's control over more than half the territory. Almost nothing has been rebuilt.

Israel has tied any progress on the other issues to Hamas' complete disarmament, while the militant group -- and the Trump administration -- say they should happen simultaneously. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu hardened his stance over the summer, openly defying Trump, his most important ally, ahead of Israeli elections later this month.

CLOSER LOOK

- The agreement halted major military operations, freed all remaining hostages and increased humanitarian access
- Netanyahu hardened his stance over the summer, openly defying Trump, his most important ally, ahead of Israeli elections later this month

The wrangling has left Gaza's 2 million Palestinians in limbo. Most are sheltering in rodent-infested tent camps, the rubble of their former neighbourhoods or war-damaged buildings at risk of collapse.

In the Jabaliya area of the northern Gaza Strip, Abdullah Abu Zubaida's family lives in a makeshift shelter built from the debris of their house.

"When the ceasefire began last October, we expected the war to halt, assassinations to cease, and aid to flow in," he said. None of that has happened.

The 20-point ceasefire agreement, reached after months of negotiations under the Biden and Trump administrations, ended major military operations and led to the return of all the remaining hostages taken in Hamas' Oct. 7, 2023, attack that ignited the war.

Hamas-led militants killed some 1,200 people that day and abducted 251.

Israel responded with massive bombardment and a ground invasion that has killed more than 74,000 Palestinians, according to the Gaza Health Ministry.

THIRD T20 INTERNATIONAL

India, Windies look for upper-hand in another bat versus bat contest

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Indore, October 10



Another bat versus bat contest is likely to exert further pressure on the bowlers who have taken enough battering already, when India and West Indies face off in the third T20 International at the Holkar Stadium's batting haven here on Sunday.

As many as 501 runs were scored in the second T20I in Ranchi with the West Indies scaling down India's massive 250-run target with more than an over to spare, prompting head coach Gautam Gambhir to throw the spotlight on the plight of bowlers for a second time in the fortnight.

But Gambhir's think tank and his bowlers, along with their peers in the opposition camp, cannot expect any immediate respite especially here in Indore, as the venue traditionally favours the batters with its flat decks and short boundary limits.

It would all thus boil down on execution across departments between the two opponents, with dropped catches and missed opportunities carrying greater significance.

Mayank Yadav spilling a regulation catch of Sherfane Rutherford halfway through the West Indies' innings proved decisive in a way as he went on to eventually add a massive 120 runs off 54 balls with skipper Shai Hope.

Rutherford was only on 38 off 18 when Mayank spilled a gobbler at short fine leg, and the Caribbean southpaw eventually finished at 84 off 37 balls, hammering seven sixes and as many fours.

India will also be wary of Hope's form at the top of the order as the West Indies captain has peeled off two centuries on this visit, displaying incredible form and skills to keep his team in contention against the home side's batting might in their backyard. For India, it would be another excellent test of finding solutions and execution with the ball, with dew also expected to play its part.

Batting first, India seemed to have put enough runs on board in Ranchi making 249 for 5, and Mayank's early inroads put them in the driver's seat. But the West Indies, unfazed by early blows, kept hitting back in perfect batting conditions to register their highest-ever run chase.

Among the bright spots for India in this series has been skipper Shreyas Iyer rediscovering his mojo after a short session with former batting coach Abhishek Nayar before departing for this series. With 102 not out and an 18-ball 40, Iyer has found his rhythm as well as solutions to key issues such as generating force with the bat and dominating bowlers, which he felt had slipped away.

Sanju Samson's 41-ball 82 to snap his ordinary run with the bat may keep Vaibhav Sooryavanshi out of the mix, as Gambhir once again reiterated the importance of flexibility in the middle-order but not at the top after the game in Ranchi.

The head coach also admitted that India will continue to experiment with their combinations after Shivam Dube walked out at No. 4 ahead of Iyer. Even though Dube fell only for seven, India are not expected to read much into it.

But India would certainly want more from their ace bowler, Arshdeep Singh, who has given away 79 runs in two matches for only one wicket in return. Mayank cranked up express pace to take two wickets upfront and three overall, and India would want the right-arm pace bowler to continue in the same manner.

KEY POINTS

- As many as 501 runs were scored in the second T20I in Ranchi with the West Indies scaling down India's massive 250-run target with more than an over to spare
- India will also be wary of Hope's form at the top of the order as the West Indies captain has peeled off two centuries on this visit
- India would certainly want more from their ace bowler, Arshdeep Singh, who has given away 79 runs in two matches for only one wicket

Renshaw scores 190 as Australia lead Proteas by 363 runs on Day 2

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Durban, October 10



Australia's Matt Renshaw plays a shot on day two of the first cricket test match between South Africa & Australia, in Durban, South Africa, Saturday AP/PTI

Matt Renshaw scored a career-best 190 runs to propel Australia to 390 all out in its first innings of the first cricket test against South Africa on Saturday.

Renshaw faced 397 deliveries in his marathon innings, hitting 21 fours and a six, as he stitched crucial lower-order partnerships to rescue Australia from 124-6 (on Day 1).

Nathan Lyon scored 27 off 92 balls, adding 134 runs off 283 balls for the ninth wicket with Renshaw, as Australia defied South Africa for much of Day 2.

South Africa finished the day at 27-1 (8.4 overs) with Australia leading by 363 runs. Play was cut short once again on Day 2, this time by 14.2 overs. Nearly 25 overs were lost on Day 1's third session.

At stumps, David Bedingham (12 not out) and Aiden Markram (15 not out) were the unbeaten batters for the hosts. Ryan Rickelton fell for a three-ball duck, caught off Josh Hazlewood.

Earlier in the day, Australia began at overnight 187-3, with skipper Pat Cummins (33) adding 10 runs to his overnight score. Wiaan Mulder picked two in the morning session, finishing with 4-68 in 27 overs.

Renshaw reached his second test hundred in the morning session – coming off 204 balls. His previous and only other hundred had come against Pakistan in 2017 – 184 in Sydney.

Australia went to lunch at 277-8, recovering from Day 1's collapse, as Lyon hung around with Renshaw – the duo added 47 off 87 balls.

They continued batting for nearly another session, putting on 100 off 213 balls of which Lyon contributed only 17 runs.

Australia crossed 300 in the second session, which seemed unlikely on Day 1 when it was down to 84-4 after opting to bat.

Renshaw completed 150 off 311 balls as the tea break came at 390-9. Marco Jansen (3-68) finally got the breakthrough by trapping Lyon lbw in the 129th over.

Renshaw notched up his test career-best before the tea break and added 26 off 52 balls with Hazlewood (5 not out) to push Australia's first innings close to 400.

Renshaw finally fell – out caught at slip to Simon Harmer – in the 138th over, scripting Australia's turnaround.

South Africa is the reigning world test champion, having beaten Australia in the 2025 final. It is Australia's first trip to the country since the 2018 ball-tampering scandal.

Six golds power Army athletes to best-ever Asian Games haul

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 10



Athletes from the Indian Army put forth their best-ever display at the Asian Games 2026 with their haul of 20 medals, comprising six gold, eight silver and six bronze medals and helping the Indian team to win almost a quarter of its medals.

The 62-member strong Army team, participating in 15 events, bagged 20 out of India's 85 medals and six of India's 21 gold medals.

Participation of the Army in the Indian team increased from nine per cent in the 2022 Games to 12.6 per cent at Asian Games 2026.

Some of the notable performances include two gold and one silver by Nb Sub Neeru Dhanda, and two silver and one bronze medal by Nb Sub Gulveer Singh.

Dhanda became the first Indian woman to win Asian Games gold in women's trap shooting.

Athletes from the Army have set national and Games records in athletics, archery, and shooting events.

Hav Sawan Barwal set a national record in men's marathon with a timing of 2:11:37, and Sub Dhiraj Bommadevara achieved 698/720 in men's recurve archery.

Additionally, the team managed to end the long periods of non-medals in their respective events, where Barwal got India's first medal in men's marathon for the Asian Games in 44 years, and Nb Sub Sarvesh Kushare bagged a medal in men's high jump after 56 years.

The performance writes down the increasing role of the Army in the sports domain in India through specialised training and coaching.

ISL: Bengaluru stage comeback to beat Delhi 3-2

AGENCIES
Bengaluru, October 10



Bengaluru FC began their Indian Super League campaign with a dramatic 3-2 comeback victory over Sporting Club Delhi in the 2026-27 season opener at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium here on Saturday.

Menno Koch scored the decisive goal in the 89th minute to secure all three points for the hosts.

Bengaluru started aggressively, pressing high and using the pace of Ryan Williams and Ashique Kuruniyan to trouble Delhi's defence.

Their approach paid off in the 22nd minute when debutant Borja Martinez opened the scoring with a left-footed strike from outside the box, finding the bottom-left corner after Ryan Williams' assist.

Delhi responded four minutes later. Young midfielder Hnamte created the opportunity for Rodriguinho, who finished from close range with his right foot in the 26th minute to level the scores.

The visitors moved ahead in the 32nd minute when Juan Pena broke into the box and delivered a dangerous cross that Koch inadvertently turned into his own net, giving Delhi a 2-1 lead at half-time.

Bengaluru restored parity in the 75th minute as Martinez completed his brace with another composed left-footed finish from the left side of the box. Mihailo Perovic provided the assist.

Substitute Soham Varshneya then injected fresh energy into Bengaluru's attack.

In the 89th minute, his cross found Koch, who headed home the winner, redeeming himself after the first-half own goal.

Delhi showed they could challenge the hosts, but Bengaluru's persistence ultimately secured a thrilling opening victory.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Menno Koch scored the decisive goal in the 89th minute to secure all three points for the hosts
- Bengaluru started aggressively, pressing high and using the pace of Ryan Williams and Ashique Kuruniyan to trouble Delhi's defence

Ex-National Golf champion Amandeep Johl elected Delhi Golf Club Captain



Amandeep Johl

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 10

In the recently held elections in the Delhi Golf Club, former national Golf champion Amandeep Johl, was declared elected Captain of the club. Johl is also a national coach and professional golfer with an association spanning five decades in the game of golf.

He is joined in the committee by a group of sporting personalities including Gaurav Ghei, first Indian to compete in a men's major Golf championship, Mansher Singh, an Arjuna awardee and celebrated international shooting champion who has represented India at various levels, Karan Atwal, a former Junior National Golf Champion and Vikram Sethi, former national Golf coach, according to a release here.

The newly elected committee is further strengthened by government nominees and other experienced members who bring valuable institutional knowledge, diverse perspectives and expertise in administration and governance.

Johl, the newly elected captain, said: "This committee brings together accomplished sportspersons who have competed, coached and represented India at the highest levels. Our endeavour is to combine this wealth of sporting experience with sound governance and professional administration of the Delhi Golf Club."

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.: Jhansi/W/T/Tender General/220-221 Date : 07.10.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and on behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through online **(E-Tendering)** for the following work.

E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-220	
Description of work : JHS/E-Construction of 8 units type II quarters at East colony on replacement account under ADEN/HQ-II/JHS.	
Approx Cost : ₹ 18029552.50	**Earnest Money :** ₹ 360600.00
Date of closing Tender : 02.11.2026 at **15:00** hrs.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Months	
E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-221	
Description of work : JHS/W-Construction of 10 units type II quarters at west colony on replacement account under ADEN/HQ-II/JHS.	
Approx Cost : ₹ 23016313.75	**Earnest Money :** ₹ 460300.00
Date of closing Tender : 02.11.2026 at **15:00** hrs.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Months	

• Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00** hrs. on **02.11.2026** • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in

2291/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No.JHS-N-W-63-26 **Date:** 09.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line **(E-Tendering)** for the following works.

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W-63-26	**Approx Cost:** ₹ 12895304.61
Description of work: "Provision of S&T work in connection with JHANSI-BINA & PARAUNA-KANPUR- Construction of Track machine stabling siding."	
Earnest Money: ₹ 257900/-	**Cost of Tender Form:** Nil
Opening of tender: 02.11.2026 Time 15:00	
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance: 12 Months	

• Tender on line can be submitted upto **15:00 hrs on 02.11.2026.** • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

(NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) 2319/26(AK)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CRPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Gagan S/o Surender Kumar R/o D-59, 3rd Floor, Om Vihar, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 92/2023 U/S 356/379/34 IPC, PS Kirti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Gagan** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Gagan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gagan** of **FIR No. 92/2023 U/S 356/379/34 IPC, PS Kirti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **13.11.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Vasundhara Azad
Chief Judicial Magistrate
Room No. 146 1st Floor, West District
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/14475/WS/2026 (Court Matter)

झारखंड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, गोड्डा 814133
(rwdgodda09@gmail.com)

शुद्धि पत्र

इस कार्यालय द्वारा आहूत ई पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 03/2026-27/R2/RWD/EE/GODDA जिसका पी.आर. संख्या 390704 (Rural Work Department) 26-27*D है में निम्न प्रकार से संशोधित किया जाता है।

क्रम	पूर्व की तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	दिनांक 03.10.2026	दिनांक 12.10.2026
2. बेवसाईट में ई निविदा की अंतिम तिथि	दिनांक 14.10.2026 को अपराहन् 5:00 बजे तक	दिनांक 17.10.2026 को अपराहन् 5:00 बजे तक
3. बेवसाईट में ई निविदा खोलने की तिथि	दिनांक 16.10.2026 को अपराहन् 03:30 बजे	दिनांक 21.10.2026 को अपराहन् 03:30 बजे

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,
कार्य प्रमंडल, गोड्डा।

PR 391535 (Rural Development) 26-27 (D)

Portugal suspends Cristiano Ronaldo, initiates disciplinary proceedings

AGENCIES
Lisbon, October 10

Portugal's football federation has suspended Cristiano Ronaldo and initiated disciplinary proceedings against him for leaving the national team camp, it said on Saturday.

The case has been referred to the federation's disciplinary investigation committee, with findings to remain confidential until the inquiry concludes.

The 41-year-old forward left the camp during the international window following a dispute with coach Jorge Jesus over playing time. Portugal won all three matches in which Ronaldo was absent or an unused substitute, while replacement Gonçalo Ramos scored three times.

Ronaldo, who has 679 million Instagram followers, said he expected suspension under federation rules but promised fans "one or more farewell matches". The regulations prescribe a suspension of one to six months, besides a fine.

Goa fight back to hold Chennaiyin to 1-1 draw

AGENCIES
Fatorda (Goa), October 10

CHIKI'S 75TH-MINUTE EQUALISER EARNED THE HOSTS A POINT IN THEIR SEASON OPENER

FC Goa and Chennaiyin FC played out a 1-1 draw in the second match of the Indian Super League 2026-2027 season here on Saturday, as Chiki's 75th-minute equaliser earned the hosts a point in their season opener.

Irfan Yadwad put Chennaiyin ahead in the 64th minute with a right-footed effort into the far corner, breaking the deadlock after a goalless first half.

Both teams had attempted to build from the back and create opportunities in the final third, but neither could find a breakthrough before the interval.

After taking the lead, Chennaiyin pushed for a second goal. Ramon Taque tested Goa's defence with a powerful attempt towards the bottom-left corner from a tight angle on the right.

Goa increased the pressure in search of an equaliser and came close in the 70th minute when Ramon unleashed a curling long-range effort that struck the post.

Goa eventually found their breakthrough in the 75th minute. Following a foul on Udanta in the attacking half, the Gaurs won a free kick, which Chiki converted with a well-directed header into the bottom-right corner to bring the scores level at 1-1.

The hosts continued to press for a winner, with Chiki attempting another effort from inside the box in the 79th minute.

Chennaiyin also threatened at the other end, as Ramon rose to meet a cross from the left but sent his header over the crossbar with the goalkeeper off his line.

Both teams continued to look for a decisive goal in the closing stages, but neither could find a winner.

Mansukh Mandaviya to inaugurate BRICS Games

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 10

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya will declare open the BRICS Traditional and Indigenous Demonstration Games 2026 in Ahmedabad on Monday, an event in which participating countries will showcase their traditional and indigenous sports and cultural practices.

"The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, Government of India, in collaboration with the Government of Gujarat, will organise the BRICS Traditional and Indigenous Sports Demonstration Games 2026 at the Veer Savarkar Sports Complex, Ahmedabad, on 12 October 2026, under India's BRICS Chairmanship,' said a PIB release.

Besides Mandaviya, the function will be attended by Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi and Raksha Nikhil Khadse, Union Minister of State for Youth Affairs and Sports, among others.

India will showcase traditional sports such as Mallakhamb, Yogasana and Kalaripayattu.

"The Games will bring together delegations from BRICS Member and partner countries to showcase traditional and indigenous sporting practices and promote cultural exchange, heritage preservation and people-to-people cooperation through sport," the release said.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.:JHS/T.D./Dra.SE./Tender/Notice/149 Date : 09.10.2026

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Sr.Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-15R, **Description of work:** OHE Modification in connection of Necessary alteration in line no.6 (PF-4 line) for making through 3rd line and provision of OHE at new line (PF-5 line) at Gwalior yard.

Approx. Cost : ₹ 1,89,08,950.40 | **Earnest Money/Bid Security:** ₹ 3,78,200.00

Date of closing Tender : 02.11.2026, 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months

(1) Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00** hrs on **02.11.2026 (2)** For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** **2318/26 (MG)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Ranveet Kaur D/o Sh. Sukhdar Singh R/o H. No. 925, H-Blcok, Raj Nagar, Part-II, Palam Vihar Colony, New Delhi** also at: **Oyolife (459), Sector-15, Patel Nagar, Gurgaon Haryana** also at: **728, Kot Khalsa Amritsar, Punjab** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 233/2016, U/s 323/342/506/507/34 IPC, PS Kapashera, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Ranveet Kaur** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Ranveet Kaur** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Ranveet Kaur** of case **FIR No. 233/2016, U/s 323/342/506/507/34 IPC, PS Kapashera, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **13.11.2026.**

By Order
Rohit Kumar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-10
Court No. 316, Dwarka Courts, New Delhi

DP/14314/SW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. & 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Pradeep Sharma @Hitin @ Huddy S/o** Shambhu **R/o**: 73F, Choori Wali Gali, Yusuf Sarai, Chankyapuri, New Delhi and **Also at** C-15, East Baldev Park, Jagatpuri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR 461/2024 U/s: 305/317(2)/318(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Jagatpuri, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Pradeep Sharma @ Hitin @ Huddy,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Pradeep Sharma @ Hitin @ Huddy,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Pradeep Sharma @ Hitin @ Huddy,** of **FIR 461/2024 U/s: 305/317(2)/318(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Jagatpuri, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 7, 2nd Floor, Shahdara District, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/14274/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

On behalf of the President of India, Chief Engineer/TSP, Northern Railway, Headquarters office, Baroda House, New Delhi-110001 invites the following tender through E-Procurement system:

Tender No	Brief Description	Cost of tender document	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Estimated Tender value (in Rs.)	Date & Time of opening of tender	Period of completion
CSP-KSF_08_2026-27	Supply of Stone chips (20 mm & 10 mm Size) and Coarse sand as per IS-383-1970 from the given sources/ quarries for a period of Two years to Concrete Sleeper Plant, Khalispur, Varanasi by road transport including loading, leading, unloading and stacking within premises of Concrete Sleeper Plant, N.Rly./Khalispur Varanasi.	NIL	6,20,100/-	3,10,03,882.00	09.11.2026 at 15.00	24 months

Note:- The complete information of above E-Procurement tender is available on website **www.ireps.gov.in**
No CSP-KSF_08_2026-26 Date 09.10.2026 3520/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

website: www.jk.prisons.in
email: prison-jk@nic.in

Phone FAX
Srinagar (May-Oct) 0194-2457969 - 2457811
Jammu (Nov-Apr) 0191-2561004 - 2561008

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF POLICE
PRISONS DEPARTMENT J&K

E-TENDER NOTICE FOR SUPPLY OF FRESH VEGETABLE ITEMS AND OF DIETARY / PULSES/CEREALS/SPICES FOR CENTRAL JAIL SRINAGAR

E-Nit No. 01 of 2026
D A T E D: - 09.10.2026

1. For and on behalf of Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, e-tenders through online mode are invited from eligible vendors/firms possessing valid FSSAI license for execution of Rate Contracts (valid for one year) for supplies of items as mentioned in **Annexure 'K' and Annexure 'L'** of this bid document.
2. Bidding documents consisting of eligibility criteria, specifications of items, *quantities*, set of terms and conditions of contract and other relevant details can be seen/downloaded from the website **www.jktenders.gov.in and www.jkprisons.in**

Schedule of tender:

a	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	**09.10.2026**
b	Period of downloading of bidding documents	**09.10.2026** from **1800 Hrs.** to **29.10.2026** up to **1600 Hrs.**
c	Bid submission Start Date and time	**19.10.2026** from **1800 Hrs.**
d	Bid submission End Date and time	**30.10.2026** up to **1600 Hrs.**
e	Date and Time of opening of Technical Bids in online mode	**02.11.2026** 1400 Hrs. in **the office of Director General of Prison J&K-Jammu**

3. **Tender Fee (Cost of tender documents)** :
An amount of ₹ 2500 (Rupees two thousand five hundred only) towards cost of tender fee has to be deposited by the bidder in the following bank account:

Name of the Account holder : FA/CAO- Prison Department, J&K.
Account Number : 0110010100000289
Name of the Bank : J&K Bank
Branch : J&K Bank Civil Sectt. Jammu
IFSC : JAKA0MOVING

Scanned copy of the receipt towards deposit of amount of tender fee has to be necessarily uploaded along with the bid documents.

i. The bidder has to submit Earnest Money of ₹8 lakh (Rupees eight Lacs only) in the form of CDR/FDR issued by a scheduled bank, drawn and pledged in favor of FA/CAO Prison department and payable at Jammu. The bidder has to upload the scanned copy of the CDR/FDR along with other documents during submission of bid within the above-mentioned date and time of bid submission.
ii. The department shall not be responsible for delay in online submission due to any reason.
iii. The tender shall be in two bid cover system (Technical Bid and Financial Bid).

DIP No:DIPK-6591/26

(Deepak Kumar) IPS
Director General of Prisons,
J&K

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (FIU), UTTARAKHAND JAL SANSTHAN, NATHANPUR, DEHRADUN- -248005

Mail ID- eewbfiu@gmail.com

Letter No. 898 **E-Tender Notice/2026-27** Date 09.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID FOR: Review of design, build, operate & management for 7 years of PASHULOK (SIRAI) Water Supply Scheme Block Doiwala District Dehradun, under World Bank funded Uttarakhand efficient Water Supply Programme (eWSP). (Through E- Procurement Portal only **www.uktenders.gov.in)**
On Behalf of Chief General Manager, Uttrakhand Jal Sansthan, Dehradun invites Bids from eligible Bidders for Review of design, build, operate & management for 7 years of PASHULOK (SIRAI) Water Supply Scheme Block Doiwala District Dehradun, under World Bank funded Uttarakhand efficient Water Supply Programme (eWSP) through E-Procurement Portal as per the following details:

S.No No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs. In Lac)	Construction / Commissioning & Trial Run/O&M Period	Cost of Document
01	Survey, Design, Construction & O&M of Water Supply Scheme consisting of supplying & laying, jointing & testing of rising mains, Supply mains, Distribution lines, Construction of Over Head Tank, Building works, providing House Service Connections along with Supply & Fixing of Mechanical Water Meters, Drilling and Development of Tubewells, SITC of Pumping Plants, Automation Works, Revenue Collection through Departmental portal and all other appurtenant Works including Civil & Electro-Mechanical works specified in the Bid document including supply of all materials, labour, T&P etc. required for proper completion of work with 07 Year Operation & Maintenance Period (Proposed works + existing system), Complete in all respect for PASHULOK (SIRAI) Water Supply Scheme Block Doiwala District Dehradun, under World Bank funded Uttarakhand efficient Water Supply Programme (eWSP)	Rs. 2407.70 Lac (GST Extra)	18 Months (Completion Perid) +4 Months (Trial & run)+ 84 Months(O&M)	Rs.5000+ 18% GST Rs.900= Rs.5900.00

Note: Further detail visit E-Procurement Portal-**www.uktenders.gov.in**

Executive Engineer (FIU)

website: www.jk.prisons.in
email: prison-jk@nic.in

Phone FAX
Srinagar (May-Oct) 0194-2457969 - 2457811
Jammu (Nov-Apr) 0191-2561004 - 2561008

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF POLICE
PRISONS DEPARTMENT J&K

E-TENDER NOTICE FOR SUPPLY OF FRESH VEGETABLE ITEMS AND OF DIETARY / PULSES/CEREALS/SPICES FOR CENTRAL JAIL SRINAGAR

E-Nit No. 01 of 2026
D A T E D:- 09.10.2026

1. For and on behalf of Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, e-tenders through online mode are invited from eligible vendors/firms possessing valid FSSAI license for execution of Rate Contracts (valid for one year) for supplies of items as mentioned in Annexure 'K' and Annexure 'L' of this bid document.
2. Bidding documents consisting of eligibility criteria, specifications of items, quantities, set of terms and conditions of contract and other relevant details can be seen/downloaded from the website **www.jktenders.gov.in and www.jkprisons.in**

Schedule of tender:.

a	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	09.10.2026
b	Period of downloading of bidding documents	09.10.2026 from 1800 Hrs. to 29.10.2026 upto1600 Hrs.
c	Bid submission Start Date and time	19.10.2026 from 1800 Hrs.
d	Bid submission End Date and time	30.10.2026 up to1600 Hrs.
e	Date and Time of opening of Technical Bids in online mode	02.11.2026 1400 Hrs. in the office of Director General of Prison J&K-Jammu

3. Tender Fee (Cost of tender documents) :
An amount of Rs. 2500 (Rupees two thousand five hundred only) towards cost of tender fee has to be deposited by the bidder in the following bank account:

Name of the Account holder : FA/CAO- Prison Department, J&K.
Account Number : 0110010100000289
Name of the Bank : J&K Bank
Branch : J&K Bank Civil Sectt.Jammu
IFSC : JAKA0MOVING

Scanned copy of the receipt towards deposit of amount of tender fee has to be necessarily uploaded along with the bid documents.

i. The bidder has to submit Earnest Money of ₹8 lakh (Rupees eight Lacs only) in the form of CDR/FDR issued by a scheduled bank, drawn and pledged in favor of FA/CAO Prison department and payable at Jammu. The bidder has to upload the scanned copy of the CDR/FDR along with other documents during submission of bid within the above-mentioned date and time of bid submission.
ii. The department shall not be responsible for delay in online submission due to any reason.
iii. The tender shall be in two bid cover system (Technical Bid and Financial Bid).

No. DGP/Proc./E-7937289/6708-09
Dated-09.10.2026
DIP No:DIP/J-12240/26

Sd/- (Deepak Kumar) IPS
Director General of Prisons, J&K

झारखण्ड सरकार

ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
कम्बाईण्ड बिल्डिग, प्रथम तल्ला, एल0सी0 रोड, धनबाद

ई– निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई–निविदा संख्या:- 19/**RWD/DHANBAD/26-27** दिनांक :-**10.10.2026**

कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र0 सं0	आईडेन्टी फिकेशन संख्या / पैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में) अंक में	अक्षर में	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	टेण्डर कॉल संख्या
1	DMFT 137/26-27	एग्यारकुण्ड	एग्यारकुण्ड प्रखण्ड अतर्गत एग्यारकुण्ड दक्षिण पंचायत अन्तर्गत नगरकनाली तपन बाउरी के घर से नीमडंगाल मोड़ होते हुए पंचायत भवन एफ0सी0आई0 गोदाम होते हुए जी0टी0 रोड तक पथ निर्माण	81.628	एकासी लाख बासठ हजार आठ सौ	6 माह	प्रथम
2	DMFT 138/26-27	एग्यारकुण्ड	एग्यारकुण्ड प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत हरि मंदिर मोदक बस्ती से राजू साव एवं तिलक धोबी के घर होते हुए जी0टी0 रोड तक पथ निर्माण	59.246	उनसठ लाख चौबीस हजार छह सौ	6 माह	प्रथम
3	DMFT 139/26-27	निरसा	निरसा प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत कुन्थल मोड़ पानी टंकी से उदयपुर काली मंदिर तक पथ का निर्माण	198.661	एक करोड़ अनठानवे लाख छियासठ हजार एक सौ	12 माह	प्रथम
4	DMFT 140/26-27	तोपचाँची	तोपचाँची प्रखण्ड के विशनपुर गोमो दुर्गा मंदिर से लक्ष्मीपुर तक पथ निर्माण	95.471	पंचानवे लाख सैतालिस हजार एक सौ	6 माह	प्रथम
5	DMFT 141/26-27	धनबाद	धनबाद प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत दामोदरपुर मुख्य सड़क श्री लव मंडल के प्लॉट से श्री तारणी प्रसाद चौधरी के घर तक एवं श्री मुन्द्रिका सिंह के घर से श्री राजू मंडल के घर तक एवं रजक जी के घर से श्री नरेश पाल के घर तक पथ निर्माण	84.245	चौरासी लाख चौबीस हजार पाँच सौ	6 माह	प्रथम
6	DMFT 44/26-27	धनबाद	वार्ड सं0 22 सिद्धू कान्हू नगर में मेन रोड से किरण सुषमा के घर तक, गली नम्बर 4 तालाब के पास ऋषि नगर में सड़क एवं नाली तथा भेलाटाँड़ भी0आई0पी0 कॉलोनी में श्याम अपार्टमेन्ट से गली नम्बर 3, 5 तक, यूनिवर्सिटी के पास गली नम्बर 01, 04, 05 में एवं लिंक गली में सड़क निर्माण	117.161	एक करोड़ सतरह लाख सौलह हजार एक सौ	09 माह	द्वितीय
7	DMFT 45/26-27	धनबाद	वार्ड संख्या 17 में मून लाइट मैरेज हॉल से भूली बस्ती होते हुए अक्ष मस्जिद तक अमन सोसाइटी गेट संख्या 01 में बिटुमिनस सड़क का जीर्णोद्धार और निर्माण कार्य	119.483	एक करोड़ उनीस लाख अड़तालिस हजार तीन सौ	09 माह	द्वितीय
8	DMFT 47/26-27	धनबाद	वार्ड संख्या 23 श्याम बिहार कॉलोनी में हिमांशु मिश्रा का घर से विनायक अपार्टमेंन्ट होते हुए बनस्थली कॉलोनी तक एवं रघुवर नगर कुँज बिहार कॉलोनी में सड़क एवं नाली निर्माण	138.664	एक करोड़ अड़तीस लाख छियासठ हजार चार सौ	09 माह	द्वितीय
9	DMFT 48/26-27	धनबाद	वार्ड संख्या 22 सुसनी लेबा में पी0सी0सी0 रोड से रघु साव के घर तक, अलीनगर मोड़ से बरवाड़ा में रोड तक गली नंबर 2, 3, 4 में सत्यम् नगर कॉलोनी एवं आयुष विहार कॉलोनी में सड़क सूसनीलेवा मिडिल स्कूल से आदिवासी बस्ती होते हुए मुख्य नाला तक नाली निर्माण	149.129	एक करोड़ उनचास लाख बारह हजार नौ सौ	09 माह	द्वितीय
10	DMFT 51/26-27	धनबाद	वार्ड संख्या 32 में बैंक मोड़ धनसार मुख्य सड़क से राजेन्द्र यादव के घर होते हुए क्वार्टर संख्या बी 26 तक कामधेनू पेट्रोल पम्प के पीछे की ओर पी0सी0सी0 सड़क का निर्माण	10.702	दस लाख सतर हजार दो सौ	04 माह	द्वितीय
11	DMFT 52/26-27	झरिया	वार्ड संख्या 37 में शिमला बहाल में अनवर मास्टर से शेरू हाउस, अफरोज हाउस से मुबारक इराकी भाया शालमुल और उसके आस–पास की गलियों, शहीद हाउस से ट्विंकल ऑटो, जाहिद मास्टर से तौसीम दुकान और भोला हाउस से अमीन बी0सी0सी0एल0 हाउस और विभिन्न स्थानों में पथ निर्माण	17.128	सतरह लाख बारह हजार आठ सौ	04 माह	द्वितीय
12	DMFT 59/26-27	धनबाद	वार्ड संख्या 31 गांधी नगर में कलपू आरा से भीम तिवारी होते हुए पोद्दार हाउस तक, साहू जनरल स्टोर से नरेश चक्की तक, पार्षद हाउस से संदीप पोद्दार हाउस तक, नटराज टावर से महेश यादव हाउस तक, मुन्ना सिंह से धुर्व सोनी हाउस मुख्य सड़क तक, गोल बिल्डिंग मनईटाँड़ से सरकार भवन वाया कृष्णा पुरी अपार्टमेंट और लिंक गली एवं अलग–अलग स्थानों पर पी0सी0सी0 सड़क का निर्माण कार्य	50.361	पचास लाख छतीस हजार एक सौ	06 माह	द्वितीय
13	DMFT 70/26-27	एग्यारकुण्ड	प्रखण्ड एग्यारकुण्ड के पंचायत शिवलीबाड़ी में कुमारधुबी मोड़ से बाजार होते हुए सिंह जी आटा चक्की तक पी0सी0सी0 पथ निर्माण।	37.349	सैतिस लाख चौतीस हजार नौ सौ	4 माह	द्वितीय
14	DMFT 71/26-27	कलियासोल	प्रखण्ड कलियासोल के पंचायत बाँदा पूरब के ग्राम कासताबाद मोड़ से कासताबाद ग्राम के शमसान घाट तक पी0सी0सी0 पथ निर्माण।	39.513	उनतालिस लाख एकावन हजार तीन सौ	4 माह	द्वितीय
15	DMFT 87/26-27	टुण्डी	टुण्डी प्रखण्ड के पंचायत बेनगरिया में पर्वतपुर REO Road से धनेश्वर रजवार के पोल्ट्री फार्म से होते हुए जोरिया धार तक पी0सी0सी0 पथ का निर्माण।	63.434	तिरसठ लाख तैतालिस हजार चार सौ	6 माह	द्वितीय
16	DMFT 88/26-27	टुण्डी	टुण्डी प्रखण्ड के कदैया पंचायत में हरि मंदिर से रंगागड़िया ईदगाह तक गार्डवाल सहित पी0सी0सी0 पथ एवं कलभर्ट का निर्माण।	82.537	बैरासी लाख तिरपन हजार सात सौ	6 माह	द्वितीय
17	DMFT 89/26-27	टुण्डी	प्रखण्ड टुण्डी ग्राम पंचायत कमारडीह में कमारडीह के उर्द स्कूल से पुरे गांव होते हुए उत्क्रमित मध्य विद्यालय कमारडीह तक पी0सी0सी0 पथ निर्माण।	33.627	तैतीस लाख बासठ हजार सात सौ	4 माह	द्वितीय

2. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि:– **21.10.2026**
3. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय:– **12.11.2026** अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक।
4. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय:– **14.11.2026** अपराह्न 3.30 बजे।
5. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता:– कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद, पिन– 826001
6. ई–निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं0– 0326–3554757
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।

PR 391513 (Rural Work Department) 26-27 (D)

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद।

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/668 Date : 09.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N. C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under :–

T. No. : 230-TRD-WC-1057-2026	**Advertised value :** Rs. 52,48,248.18
Description of work : 25 kV OHE modification due to raising of platform at Manzoorgarhi (MZGI), Sasni (SNS) Railway stations and TRR(P) works in Prayagraj Division.	
Bid Security : Rs. 1,05,000.00	**Completion Period :** 12 Months
Bidding System : Single Packet	
Tender Closing date & Time : 30.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs	
Tender opening date & Time : 30.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs	

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. **2.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. **3.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **2320/26 (AS)**

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No: GEM/2026/B/8137936 **Date:** 09.10.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering) / North Central Railway / Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to **30.10.2026.** The details of the tenders are as under:-

Gem Bid Number: GEM/2026/B/8137936 dated 09.10.2026

Name of work: Night patrolling during cold weather on track for protection including emergency repair works and other associated works under jurisdiction of ADEN/FZD and ADEN/ETW.

Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 1,27,04,889.60	**Earnest Money (Rs.):** ₹ 2,13,530.00
DOC: 03 Months	**Date of Closing:** 30.10.2026
Eligibility Criteria for Similar Work: Any P. Way work	

Note:- (1) Tender on line can be submitted up to the due date of tender closing. **(2)** The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website **www.gem.gov.in.** up to the due date of tender closing. **2317/26 (A)**

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. PRYJ-Sig-211-2026-27

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **12:00** hrs. **The details of the Tender is as under:-**

Tender No. : PRYJ-Sig-211-2026-27	**Approx. Cost of work (₹) : 20289001.68/-**
Name of work : Comprehensive AMC of SMPS based IPS systems (Statcon Make) installed at Stations and relay huts/LSC Gate in Section MTO to BDN of Prayagraj Division for a period of thirty Six Months.	
Bid Security (₹) : 405800/-	**Completion Period : 36 Months**
Date of Opening of tender : 10.11.2026	
Availability of tender form : Tender forms shall be available on **www.ireps.gov.in**	
Time date & place of opening of tender : Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre determined date at 12:30 hours. **2305/26 (C)**	

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UJVN Limited

UJVNL
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone : 0135-2763808, Fax : 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 933 **Tender Cancellation Notice** **Dated : 10/10/2026**

Due to unforeseen reason the e- Tender No. 10/EE(E&M)/PB/2026-27 for the work of "Hiring consultancy services for Dam/Barrage break Analysis, Preparation of EAP, Vulnerability & Hazard Classification report as per 'Vulnerability & hazard classification of Dam/barrages Regulation 2024' of Virbhadra barrage, Rishikesh Distt. Dehradun" invited by the office of Executive Engineer (E&M), Pashulok Barrage, Rishikesh is hereby declared as cancelled.

Executive Engineer (E&M)
Pashulok Barrage-Rishikesh

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. PRYJ/Br/L/2026-27/02 **Dated: 05.10.2026**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Engineer/Bridge/Line/North Central Railway/Prayagraj acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-TENDERS on prescribed form for the following work up to **14:30 hrs. on 05.11.2026**. The details of the Tender are as under:-

Tender No.: 2026-02	**Approx. Cost of work (Rs.):** 15,89,95,457.28
Name of Work: Provision of 6.1M wide new FOB with Ramp at Phaphund (PHD) station and Replacement of old FOB by 6.10M wide new FOB at Bharthana (BNT) station for recoupment of Divyangjan Facility between CNB-TDL section of Prayagraj Division.	
Bid Security (Rs.): 31,79,900/-	**Completion Period:** 12 Months
Date of Opening of tender: 05.11.2026.	
Eligibility Criteria For similar work: Fabrication and erection/launching of steel bridges/ FOB	

Note: (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **14:30 hrs.** on the due date of tender opening i.e. **05.11.2026. (2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. **(3)** Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightway ignored and shall not be considered. **(4)** Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. **(5)** Payment of Bid Security/Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) & Tender Document Cost (TDC) in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through net banking or payment gateway only. **(6)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **(7)** On line tender can be submitted up to **14.30 hrs. on 05.11.2026. (8)** Supplier of Goods and/or services would be a subject to GST Act. and Rules as applicable from time to time. **(9)** The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause **10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC July'2022** mandatorily, otherwise offer will be treated as Incomplete offer and accordingly shall not be considered. **2300/26(K)**

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. 8620262027 **Date: 09.10.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to **13:30** hrs. **on 02.11.2026**. The details of the tenders are as under:

SN	Tender No.	Approx. Cost of work (₹)	Bid security (₹)
1	182	₹ 30047384.63	₹ 601000.00
Name of work: AAP-SB: Improvement of RUBs No. 7,96,97,98 & 99 on main line section for protection of water seepage and other miscellaneous works under ADEN/ETW.			
2	183	₹ 42002519.52	₹ 840100.00
Name of work: JGR-TDL: Improvement of RUBS No. 38,40,41,53,54,55 & 57 on main line section for protection of water seepage and other miscellaneous works under ADEN/FZD.			
3	184	₹ 30729342.76	₹ 614600.00
Name of work: Cess repair work under ADEN/FZD			

Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Sr No. 1 & 2: Seepage protection or strengthening of Bridges/Tunnels/ Reservoirs/Any Important civil engineering structures by Cement/Epoxy grouting or by hydro reactive Polyurethane (PU) resin grouting or by any advanced method use for seepage protection. **Sr No. 3:** Earth work in formation.

Completion Period: 12 months	**Date of Opening of tender:** 02.11.2026

Note: 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders is available on website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **13:30** hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e **02.11.2026.** The tender shall be opened at or after 15:00 hrs on due date of opening. **2.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. **3.** Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. **4.** Tender Nos. 182 to 184 are having advertised value more than ₹50 Lakhs, therefore, Annexure-V & V(A) (Document Verification Certificate) is required. The supplier/ contractor of goods and/or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. **5.** This tender notice has also been uploaded on **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. 6.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **7.** Tender online can be submitted up to **13:30** hrs. on **02.11.2026. 8.** E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. **9. For tender nos. 182 to 184: The tenderers have to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-1) of IRGCC-2022 (Works matter) mandatorily, otherwise their offer will be considered as Incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered.** **2311/26(AK)**

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AI, Yes. But Please Make It Human

From a child's eyesight in India to market produce in Kenya and job-seekers in Mexico, a new generation of young women is using artificial intelligence not to chase the spectacular, but to solve problems close to home. And it is working







MPOST BUREAU

Seeing what others miss is a unique quality. That is what happened with Faria and Suha Zubair, who began looking for answers to their brother Zain's strabismus. The last thing on their minds was a desire to change the way artificial intelligence was used in healthcare. They were thinking about a child, a person, a brother.

Strabismus, in which the eyes do not align properly, can go unnoticed in children. Left untreated, it can permanently affect vision and quietly erode a child's confidence. For families far from specialists, getting the right diagnosis and treatment can be expensive and difficult.

The Zubair sisters' answer, Strabi-Cure, was as simple as it was inventive. It uses a smartphone camera to screen for the condition, followed by gamified eye exercises and progress tracking. Even its home therapy device, made with biodegradable jute string, has been designed around affordability.

It is a small intervention aimed at a very real problem. And that is what makes it so interesting: the sisters have found a simple, practical use for AI.

Their story is part of a much larger effort being encouraged through the AI Ventures Accelerator, supported by UNICEF Generation Unlimited and Technovation, giving young people the opportunity to look at problems around them and ask a deceptively simple question: "Can AI help?" If it can, how can we make it help? That is a different way of looking at artificial intelligence, far removed from the one that dominates the world's AI conversation.

Making People Visible

In Rwanda, Amen Divine grew up watching her mother work as a loans officer at a local bank. She saw people with functioning businesses—tailors, market vendors and motorcycle-taxi riders—walk in looking for credit and walk out without it. The problem was not necessarily that their businesses were bad. It was just that the financial system could not see them at all. They had no conventional collateral, little or no credit history and few of the documents that formal lending systems rely on. Economically, they were active. Financially, they were invisible.

Divine's PACIN, the Pan-African Credit Intelligence Network, is designed to change that. The system brings together everyday financial signals such as mobile-money transactions and remittances, using them to generate AI-based credit scores. The scores are designed to explain why a person has received a particular assessment.

PACIN does not lend the money. It gives lenders something they were missing: information. The team built its architecture in 60 days, interviewed over 30 small-business owners, and is working towards its first live data integrations in Kenya and Nigeria. There is something powerful about the idea: AI is not replacing the banker; it is helping him notice a customer who was already there.

Opening A Door

In Mexico, the problem looks different. Across Latin America, millions of young people struggle to find work because employers want experience they have never had the opportunity to acquire. The founders of CONCORA know that trap personally. Their answer is to change the question itself.

Instead of asking a young applicant to prove experience on a résumé, CONCORA allows companies to set real business challenges. Candidates respond with a video pitch and a demonstration of what they can do. An AI-powered skills assessment called Brújula—Spanish for compass—maps a young person's strengths and gaps, helping create a path forward. For companies, the proposition is equally practical: rather than sort through applications for months, they receive five pre-vetted finalists in two weeks.

Launched in March 2026, CONCORA has reached 1,900-plus users in nine Latin American countries, conducted more than ten hiring challenges and closed four pilots. Most of its users are women.

Its message to applicants is mischievous in its simplicity: "By applying, you already have experience." That kind of idea makes AI feel less like a machine from the future and more like a door that somebody has finally figured out how to open.

Thomas Michael Kaye, Senior Adviser, Global Solutions, Generation Unlimited, UNICEF, explains: "These girls have shown us creativity, persistence and the power of partnerships. Our approach was simple—seek out young girls and women who had identified local problems and wanted to bring about change. Through this programme and with AI tools, they have managed to bring about change."

Rekindling Markets

In Africa's informal food markets, another problem is brutally physical. Produce spoils. For small-scale vendors, many of them women, a crate of vegetables going bad is not an abstract supply-chain inefficiency. It is lost income. Sometimes, it is the difference between making the day's money and going home with a loss.

In Kenya, KilimoChills is using AI to tackle the problem from inside a solar-powered cold-storage system designed specifically for informal markets. Its modular units have three temperature zones. Sensors monitor them, while an AI model looks for early signs that a compressor may fail—before a trader loses any stock. Another model studies local sunlight patterns and determines when the system should draw power from solar panels, batteries or the grid. The result is striking: post-harvest losses have been reduced by over 80 per cent.

There is another dimension to the project. The founders have also studied the devastating effect of fires in crowded markets, where one disaster can wipe out years of work. Protecting the livelihoods of women traders is not an incidental benefit; it is part of the reason the system exists. This is AI doing something gloriously unglamorous.

Keeping vegetables cold. Because sometimes, that is where technology matters most.

BEYOND GIANT DATA CENTRES AND EXISTENTIAL QUESTIONS SURROUNDING AI, A QUIET REVOLUTION IS TAKING SHAPE. YOUNG PEOPLE ARE USING TECHNOLOGY TO FIND PRACTICAL ANSWERS TO EVERYDAY PROBLEMS

Catching the Machine

If KilimoChills makes AI practical, Glitch Detectives makes it playful. The Nigerian project turns a familiar classroom activity upside down. Instead of giving children a math problem and asking them to find the answer, it gives them an answer that contains a mistake.

An AI companion called ZED-4 presents the work. The child becomes the investigator. Find the glitch. Work out what went wrong. Repair it. Then explain the mistake in your own words. Designed for children from kindergarten through sixth grade, the platform uses interactive missions and printable activities without timers or pressure. The intention is important, more so in a world where children will increasingly encounter AI-generated answers.

The lesson is not simply mathematics. It is scepticism. A machine can be impressive and still be wrong. And for children growing up in a world filled with AI-generated answers, learning to question what a machine tells them may become as important as learning to find the answer itself. There is something deliciously appropriate about this. At a time when adults are worrying about whether humans will surrender too much to machines, these children are being taught something wonderfully simple: Don't automatically believe the machine. Check it. Challenge it. And, when necessary, correct it.

In teaching children, the girls behind the projects have transformed their own outlook as well. Rebecca Anderson, Chief Learning and Innovation Officer at Technovation, found this the most rewarding part of the programme– "It has been so exciting to see these girls grow with their projects." She says while some projects may have qualified for further development, every single project is unique in itself. "All 200-plus teams that completed the programme have won."

Finding a Voice

In Kazakhstan, for instance, Diana Murzagaliyeva knows the problem her technology is trying to solve because she lived it herself. She struggled with a speech disorder. Across the country, many children with speech difficulties face long waits for therapy or have no access to it at all, particularly outside major cities where specialists are scarce.

SpeakUp is designed to put that support into an app. The system listens to unclear speech, converts it into text and gives children real-time feedback through games. A virtual character called Speechy provides another important ingredient: a space where practising does not feel like being judged. Parents and therapists can track progress through reports.

The beta version has already been tested with more than 500 children, with pilots running in schools and speech-therapy centres. Again, the technology is not the story by itself. The story is what the technology allows a child to do: Speak. Try again. Speak better. And soon, speak without being afraid.

A Different Story

Put these projects together and a different picture of artificial intelligence emerges. It is not the AI of giant laboratories. It is not measured in billions of dollars, processors deployed or models trained on massive quantities of data.

It can be a smartphone camera looking at a child's eyes; a credit system trying to see the economic reality of a market trader; a hiring platform giving a young person a chance to demonstrate what they can do; a solar refrigerator keeping vegetables from spoiling; a cartoon AI character teaching a child to look for a mistake; or a virtual companion helping another child find the confidence to speak.

None of these projects will settle the great arguments about AI. They are not supposed to. They start with a person, a place and a problem. Perhaps that is another way to think about the AI revolution. Not every breakthrough needs to be enormous. Not every useful application needs a billion-dollar valuation. Not every piece of technology needs to change the world.

Sometimes, it is enough to change one corner of it. Then another. And another. Until, almost without noticing, the future arrives not with a bang, but as a child seeing clearly, a trader protecting her day's income, a young woman getting a fairer shot at a job, or a child discovering that even a machine can be wrong. It may not be the world's loudest AI story. But it may be one of its most hopeful.

1
CAR, SEVEN JOBS

5
CARS, ONE DRIVER?

∞
CARS, THE WAY OUT?

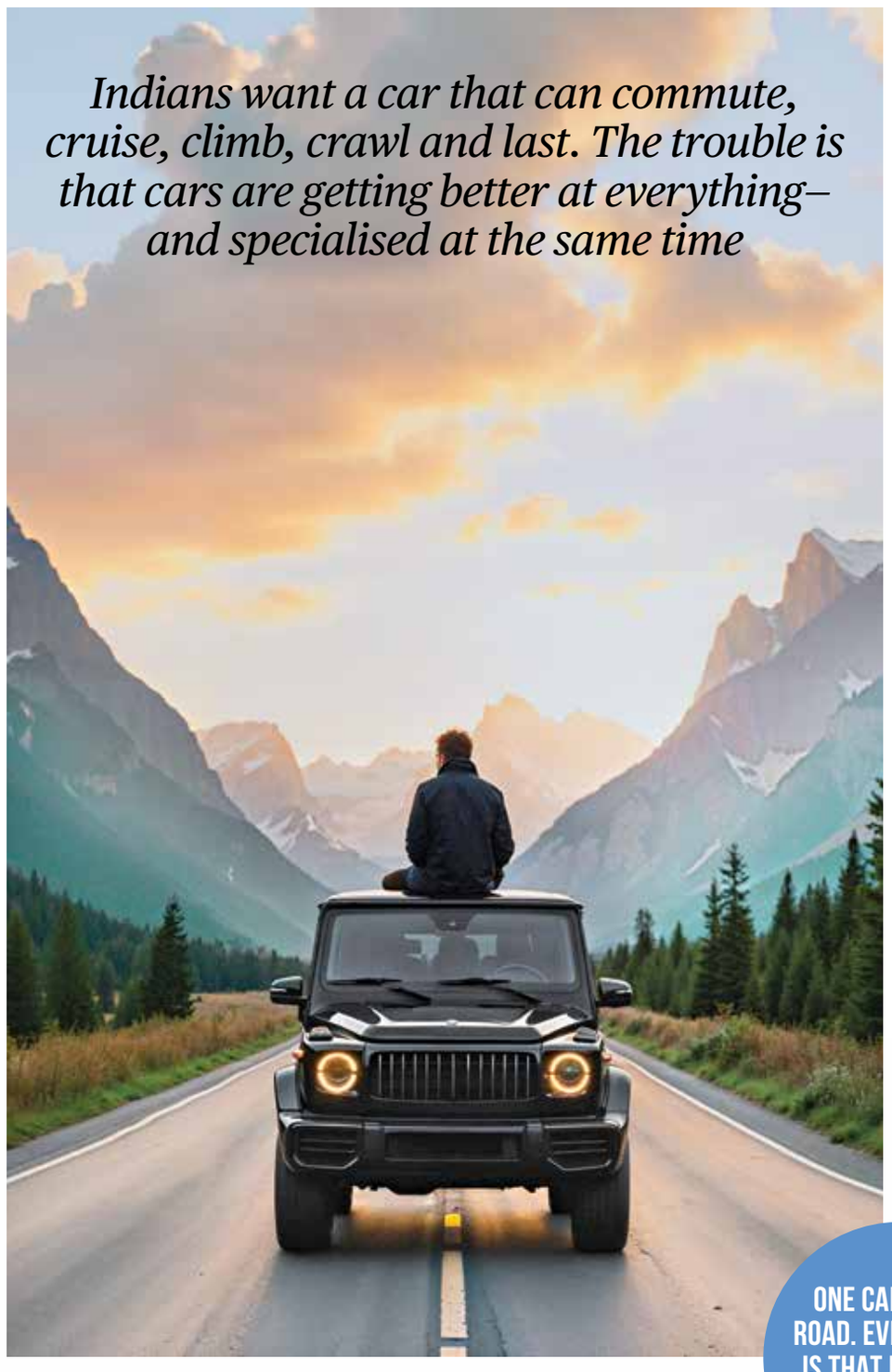
I Want One Car. That Does It All

AUTHOR



RAJEEV NARAYAN

Indians want a car that can commute, cruise, climb, crawl and last. The trouble is that cars are getting better at everything– and specialised at the same time



I want a car that can cruise at 120 kmph all day. Climb a mountain when I feel adventurous. Survive a road that disappeared three kilometres ago. Crawl through city traffic without making my left leg hate me. Return decent mileage. Run without trouble for 15 years. And still fetch a respectable price when I finally decide to let it go. It is not an unreasonable request, is it? After all, it is only a car.

Except that it is not. Modern Indian car buyers wants a vehicle that can do almost everything. Monday to Friday, it must be comfortable in traffic. On Saturday, it should be happy on a highway. On holiday, it should take the family up a mountain. And if the mountain road suddenly becomes a suggestion rather than real tarmac, it should not panic.

It should be automatic, economical, reliable, comfortable, spacious, powerful enough, tough enough and preferably not ruinous to maintain. In short, I want one machine to behave like five.

City vs Country

The problem begins when the car leaves the showroom. City driving rewards compact dimensions, light controls, good visibility, an automatic gearbox and the ability to squeeze into spaces designed before SUVs took over our world. A tall, heavy, four-wheel-drive machine may look wonderfully reassuring... Until it has to make a U-turn in a crowded market.

Go to the hills and the priorities change. Ground clearance suddenly matters. So does traction. And suspension travel. And torque. A car that felt perfectly adequate in the city can begin to look less convincing when the tarmac disappears and the road starts climbing at an angle that makes passengers stop talking. And start praying.

Then there are the highways. Here, what most drivers want is simple: stability, quietness, good seats, strong brakes and an engine that does not feel as if it has been brought up on dalia and tori when pushed to 120 kmph. The trouble is that every one of these virtues comes with a price.

Make a car tough enough for bad roads and it becomes heavier. Make it bigger and it becomes less convenient in town. Give it serious off-road ability and fuel efficiency suffers. Make it small and efficient and it is not the machine you want when the road turns into a rocky track. Or no track. The perfect compromise remains stubbornly elusive.

Automatics Rule

There is, however, one part of the dream that has already arrived. The clutch pedal is slowly becoming a memory. For anyone who learnt to drive in India's old traffic, this is not a small development. There was a time when driving through a city meant repeatedly pressing a clutch, selecting first gear, moving two metres, stopping, pressing the clutch again and wondering why your left leg had been singled out for this torture chamber.

Today, even relatively affordable cars offer automatic or clutch-free transmissions. AMTs, IVTs, CVTs, DSGs, DCTs and torque converters have made the three-pedal car difficult to justify for someone spending hours in traffic. That has also changed what people expect from a car. We no longer want to work the machine. We want the machine to work for us.

But there is a catch. The more sophisticated the gearbox, electronics and connected technology become, the more complicated the car becomes too. And the Indian buyer still has another requirement sitting quietly at the back of the mind: Will it still be working properly 10 years from now?

ONE CAR. EVERY ROAD. EVERY MOOD. IS THAT POSSIBLE, OR AN IMPOSSIBLE BRIEF?

Fifteen-Year Test

This is where the old logic of car buying still refuses to disappear. People may talk about screens, ADAS, panoramic sunroofs and connected technology, but ask an Indian family what it really wants from a car and the answer is often brutally practical: Will it last?

This is why brands with reputations for durability command a different kind of loyalty. A car that starts like a good boy every morning for 12-15 years has delivered something that cannot be measured by the number of features on its specification sheet.

Then comes the resale. The Indian car is rarely just transportation. It is also an asset. We may buy it new, drive it for years, complain about its mileage, curse its service bill and occasionally threaten to replace it. But when the time comes, we still want somebody else to pay a respectable amount for it.

That creates a peculiar equation. We want the newest technology but old-fashioned reliability. We want more power but better mileage. We want bigger cars but lower running costs. We want sophisticated electronics but mechanical simplicity. We want an SUV but city-car dimensions. And we want all of it at a price that makes sense.

Multi-Car Answer?

Maybe this is why the Indian automobile market has become so fragmented. There are cars for cities, cars for highways, cars for families, cars for rough roads, cars for fuel economy and cars for people who want to be noticed. There are petrols, diesels, CNGs, hybrids, plug-in hybrids, full-blown EVs and cars that are a combination of several of these ideas. The industry keeps giving us more choices. Yet, the consumer keeps asking for the same thing: Can I have one car that does everything?

Perhaps the honest answer is no. Perhaps the better answer is that we have been looking at the question the wrong way. The perfect car may not be the one that does everything brilliantly. It may be the one that does most things well enough, most of the time, without making you think about what it cannot do.

A car that is comfortable in traffic, relaxed on a highway, competent on a mountain road, reasonably economical, dependable for years and still desirable when you are ready to sell it. That sounds less like a fantasy and more like the holy grail of the Indian motoring mindset. When you find one, do not tell me.

Because I am looking for it too.



Wellness

Beyond the Mental Health Conversation



Breaking the silence is only the beginning of meaningful mental healthcare

AUTHOR



ERA DUTTA

Mental health has officially entered the chat. It is on Instagram, in college conversations, at workplaces and increasingly around the dinner table. A generation ago, saying "I am seeing a psychiatrist" could invite uncomfortable questions. Today, a young person might casually tell a friend, "I have started therapy."

Gen Z deserves some credit for this shift. They have made it easier to talk about anxiety, depression, burnout, ADHD, trauma and relationships. They have questioned the idea that struggling should always be kept private.

But there is a problem.

We have become better at "talking" about mental health than "understanding it".

Social media's role in mental health awareness

Social media has made mental health information incredibly accessible. It has also made self-diagnosis incredibly easy. A checklist of ADHD symptoms can feel very convincing. A video about narcissism can suddenly explain every bad relationship you have ever had. A post about depression can make an ordinary period of sadness look like a psychiatric disorder. Mental health awareness should make us more informed, not more frightened about ourselves.

World Mental Health Day

This year's World Mental Health Day theme, "Lived Experiences Heard: Real Voices, Real Change," takes the conversation one step further. It asks us to listen to people who have actually experienced mental illness and use what they tell us to improve healthcare, workplaces, policies and support systems.

That matters because mental illness is not just a diagnosis on paper. A patient knows what it feels like to sit in a waiting room, terrified of being judged, and the embarrassment of buying medication from the nosy local chemist. A person recovering from addiction knows how difficult it can be to return to ordinary life while others think it's their lifestyle choice. Someone living with depression knows that "just get out of bed" is not treatment, and a person battling OCD (obsessive-compulsive disorder) cannot just STOP washing their hands or inhibit their thoughts. Their experiences should shape the systems we build.

What are the common disorders?

Globally, anxiety and depression are among the most common mental health conditions. But the spectrum is much wider, including bipolar disorder, schizophrenia, OCD, PTSD, eating disorders, ADHD and substance use disorders. India faces many of the same challenges, with additional barriers created by stigma, lack of awareness and unequal access to mental healthcare.

NOT EVERY DIFFICULT EMOTION IS A PSYCHIATRIC DISORDER

Is there treatment available?

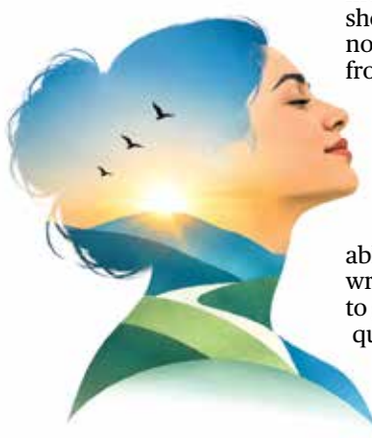
The encouraging part is that mental health conditions are treatable. Treatment can involve psychotherapy, medication, family support, lifestyle changes, rehabilitation or a combination of these. There is no single treatment that works for everyone.

Is it expensive?

Help is available even when money is a barrier. Tele-MANAS, the Government of India's national tele-mental health service, provides free, 24-hour support at 14416 or 1800 89 14416.

What should mental health awareness look like?

Perhaps this is what mental health awareness should ultimately look like: not diagnosing ourselves from Instagram, nor pretending everything is fine. At the same time, it should not mean turning every difficult emotion into a disorder, but being able to say, "Something is wrong," knowing where to go, finding someone qualified to listen and getting the help we need, just like with any other physical illness.



Between the Sacred and the Forbidden

The Dark Hours of the Night *captures women's intimate struggles against deeply entrenched patriarchal expectations*

AUTHOR



YAUVANIKA CHOPRA

On an early evening of Ramzan, in a village in Tamil Nadu, two young girls wait for a crescent moon in a sky that is mostly clear, mostly the colour of the faded blue sari which one's mother uses to dry vadagam. There is a small cluster of clouds which looks to Rabia like the foam which collects under the washing stone. In another corner towards the south is one single little cloud, separate from the rest, which looks as if it is sulking – waiting, away from the others. Rabia feels a little pang of pity for the solitary cloud, and then laughs quietly at her own flight of fancy.

If Mathina, sitting next to her, had known about this thought, she would have laughed too. Not because she doesn't love Rabia – she does, with all her heart – but because it is such a characteristically irrepressible expression of her best friend's whimsical sensitivity. The friendship between Rabia and Mathina provides consolation for every potential sorrow, and there are no lies between them – except those few necessitated by circumstance or ordered by their mothers.

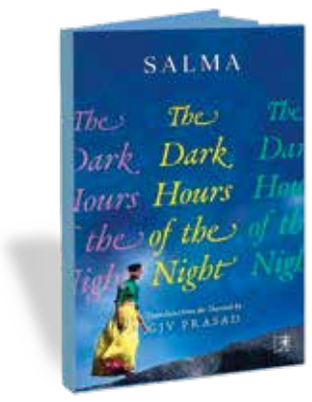
Rabia is from a prosperous, conservative family mired in complex relationships. She could perhaps be seen as our protagonist, but this is not truly a book about any one single person. There is Rabia's mother Zohra – proud, proper – and Zohra's mother Ameena – protective over her mother Kathija, who walked with a limp ever since a grindstone fell on her foot in childhood; protective over her daughter Firdaus, who inherited Kathija's beauty and feels love sinking into her frozen life as roots that unfurl over her body. There is Zohra's sister-in-law Raima, whose opinions are not valued although she knows the world; Zohra's maidservant Fathima who acts on her desire; Zohra's inexplicable companion Mariyayi whose love for one man is endless. These are not truths that Rabia sees – she frequently misses layers in conversation because her attention is focused on chocolate rather than the gossip-news which visitors also carry – but through Rabia, we see Firdaus Chitti through a different lens, and we know that Wahida Akka hums cinema songs instead of tasbih prayers.

This densely-peopled novel by Salma was originally published in Tamizh in 2006 as Irandam Jaamangalin Kathai. For it to have been met with resistance at that time rhymes with the history of the court case against "obscenity" in 1944 which Ismat Chughtai had to go through for her short story "Lihaaf". To depict women's realities in artistry is thus rendered vulgar because it departs from sanitised convention in representing women – women who will be women, with their own shadows and joys.

Salma's skilful depiction of human psychology and the vivid eroticism, as exemplified in this book, have previously been translated by Lakshmi Holmstrom as The Hour Past Midnight, published by Zubaan in 2016. GJV Prasad's translation style in this edition, focusing on a deliberately Indian English inflexion, refracts the original in a way that is both immersive and effective. The truths of relationships – especially when fraught by gender – become a kaleidoscope of patterns across perception.

Take young Ahmad, who also loves Rabia with all his heart, but cannot let this reflect as ease.





He has his own rivalry at perceived injustice from Mathina, and consequently Rabia: "They had sneered at him so much for having taken a few coins to learn how to cycle. Now, they would be astonished if they saw him riding with such style! Let's see how they make fun of me after this, he thought." Ahmad has to get ahead of the girls; he has to make fun of them before they can slight him; his taunts are mostly about the colour of their skin and their general incompetence. Rabia is bothered by these unjustified cruelties. "Why did he act like this? There were so many things she could learn from him, so many games they could play together. But she couldn't do any of it because he was always making fun of her. She could have caught dragonflies, butterflies and bees with him. He knew how to ride a bike, make kites..."

These differences of experience and understanding remain in adult marriages too. "Who is moral in this town, tell me?" asks Karim Machan rhetorically of his wife Zohra when she brings up a moral quandary of marriage which would affect their niece Wahida, "Men will be men. It's wrong only when women behave like that." And because some men will be men in these strange and stifling ways, even the worries that Karim has in common with his wife are not actually shared with his wife. "He firmly believed that sharing his confusions with her would be giving her too much respect... All the same, he tossed and turned in bed all night. When Zohra asked him what the matter was, he shut her down, saying 'Nothing.'"

Karim's brother Kadar has a similar question for his wife Raima when she raises the same concern, and he similarly holds no real expectation of an answer: "Is there a pure man in this entire world?" But Kadar cannot eventually avoid the regret of having dismissed Raima's valid concerns: "His guilt for having completely ignored Raima's opinion had troubled him for some days, and he had struggled to cope with it. Even if he did nurse a complaint against her, how was he justified in ignoring her so completely?" Kadar and Karim also realise, in an odd symmetry, the distance they have kept from their daughters. Quite without intention, they seem to have become fathers with little idea about the interior or exterior worlds inhabited by Wahida and Rabia.

Those worlds with their beauty and oppressiveness are expressed in Salma's voice, brought to new dawn through GJV Prasad, in a keen meditation on constrained choice versus unavoidable naseeb. The mask of religious sanction is drawn back, and an unthinking human impulse of preserving power is revealed to be spreading out behind its curtain. There is much to recognise in the wry narration of these young girls as they wait to come of age and dream about food whilst also trying sincerely to focus instead on the penance of experiencing hunger which they know to be the religious purpose of fasting. They make every effort to follow their mothers' advice even when it is contradictory and confusing: hold shame as honour; accept inequality of freedom as natural; repress what is difficult to understand. And yet – despite it all – there are those who insist on altering what the world has deemed to be their unalterable destinies: "What made her so daring a woman? Just this body and its needs?"

THROUGH INTIMATE RELATIONSHIPS, SALMA REVEALS HOW WOMEN NAVIGATE DESIRE, FAITH AND INHERITED RESTRICTIONS

Growing Dangers of a Warming Himalaya

Recent Himalayan catastrophes have underscored the urgent need for stronger climate adaptation strategies

AUTHOR



KRISHNA GUPTA

Two devastating events in quick succession have brought forth the special challenge that mountains and glaciers pose in the face of climate change: the Broad Peak tragedy in late July 2026, where ten elite mountaineers perished, and the catastrophic floods in Nepal in late August 2026, which led to more than 1,000 deaths and massive destruction of infrastructure (such as power plants and roads) and houses. Both events had similar proximate causes: the loosening of a large cornice or serac, which broke away from a snowy rib in the case of Broad Peak, and the loosening of a 'hanging glacier' from the underlying slope, leading to massive volumes of water flowing down the Bhote Koshi River once the melted glacier broke free from its loose boundary. The ultimate cause was the rise in greenhouse gas emissions, which is leading to global warming and erratic weather around the world. In this three-part article, we will first look at the devastation in Nepal in the first article and the Broad Peak tragedy in the second article, and relate these to our economic and scientific models discussed earlier.

The Nepal floods

From publicly available information, it appears that the Nepal floods were caused by the collapse of a glacier and rock, which fell into the Lhende River. This happened in the upper reaches of the Tibetan Himalayas in Langtang National Park and led to massive volumes of water travelling at a speed of about 170 km per hour, destroying everything in their path, including the hydel power plants on the Trishuli River, roads, bridges, houses and other buildings. Some others have suggested that the floods were caused by the bursting of a glacial lake (or GLOF: Glacial Lake Outburst Flood) formed by the breaking away of a huge chunk of glacier. Whatever the cause, the devastation was unprecedented, and the death toll is reported to be more than 1,000, though many others may have perished.

Interestingly, such ice and rock falls or glacial floods in the Himalayas, the Karakoram and other high-altitude mountains are not new. An event that was very similar to the Nepal floods was the glacial and rock avalanche in Chamoli, Uttarakhand, in February 2021, which led to the destruction of power plants on the Rishiganga River and the washing away of infrastructure. The catastrophic GLOF in October 2023 in Sikkim and West Bengal is still fresh in the collective memory, and the region has yet to fully recover from the destruction of hydropower plants, roads and bridges. In this event, a massive chunk of the South Lhonak Glacier in North Sikkim triggered a GLOF, which led to massive volumes of water rushing into the Teesta River. In August 2025, a similar GLOF was witnessed in Dharali, Uttarakhand, causing massive floods on the route to Gangotri. There have been hundreds of such events across the Himalayas and Karakoram.

Many reports of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) have warned of unstable glaciers and the threat of GLOFs, as has research on glaciers and mountain climate. Data compiled by the International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development (ICIMOD), Kathmandu, and other research published in Nature (and npj Natural Hazards) tell us that there has been a fivefold rise in the occurrence of GLOF events since 1950. Further, a large majority of these events occur during the summer monsoon months because of high temperatures leading to ice melt. Erratic monsoons, which lead to heavy rainfall over short periods, exacerbate this danger. Other related causes, such as permafrost thawing due to climate change as well as the destabilisation of underlying slopes, create a recipe for disasters waiting to happen. The scale of these disasters is so massive that no country's disaster management apparatus or early warning systems can adequately deal with them, leaving people completely helpless.

One widely cited study is the article titled "Glacial lakes and GLOFs in a warming Himalaya-Karakoram region: current understanding, challenges, and the way forward", published in npj Natural Hazards in January 2026 by Abid Farooq Rather, Rayees Ahmed, Ashim Sattar and others. It has highlighted the dangers of GLOFs, their changing nature and what can be done to adapt better to such events in the future. The article finds that global warming has led to chunks of glaciers breaking apart and forming large numbers of glacial lakes. These pose an ever-present danger, and most of them are not being monitored. Similar research articles in Nature and ICIMOD publications have found that such glacial lakes or unstable glaciers may impact millions of people in China/Tibet and South Asian countries where the Himalayan and Karakoram ranges are located.



RISING TEMPERATURES ARE TURNING FRAGILE MOUNTAIN ECOSYSTEMS INTO DISASTER ZONES



Neeru Dhanda



Swapnil Kusale



Neeraj Chopra



Mirabai Chanu



Suruchi Singh

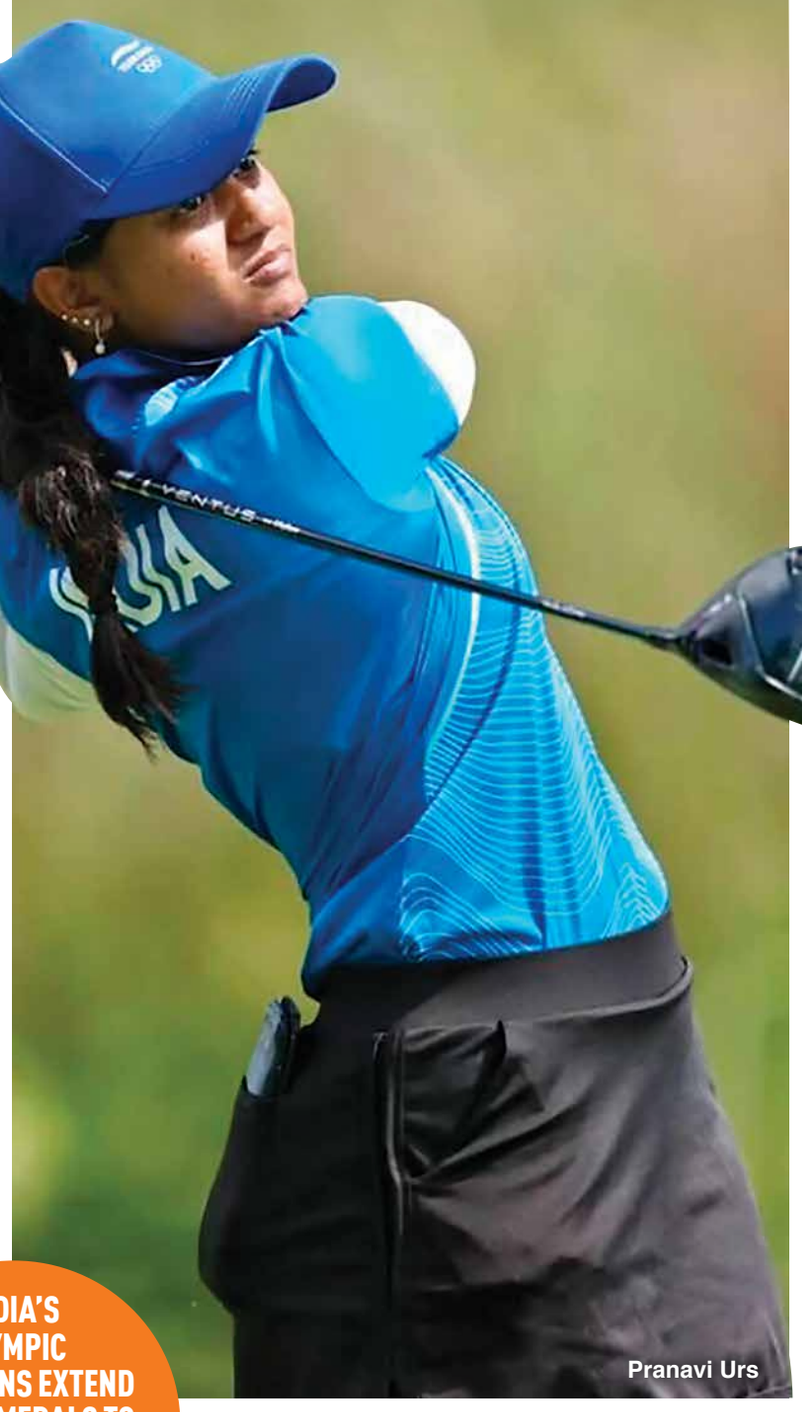
THE LONG ROAD TO OLYMPIC GLORY

AUTHOR



S KANNAN

FROM IMPROVING MEDAL PROSPECTS TO BUILDING WORLD-CLASS INFRASTRUCTURE, INDIA'S OLYMPIC AMBITIONS HAVE ENTERED A CRUCIAL PHASE OF PLANNING AND EXECUTION



Pranavi Urs

A week after the Asian Games ended in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, Indian sport remains a chaotic kaleidoscope. Reviews and post-mortems, so typical of 'babudom', were expected. The fact is, all this will serve no purpose. Sport is not about what went wrong. Time wasted on it is futile. Moving ahead, the prescription is to focus on the next goal(s) and determine what can be done.

With less than 21 months to go before the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, Indian sport needs to work hard, in tandem, and soar. The elite athletes will slog, leave no stone unturned and try to attain qualifying marks for the LA Olympics. Even then, there is no guarantee that a medal will come for sure. Why do I state this? Because an impression has been created by folks in the Sports Ministry as if 35 athletes turned out to be 'cheats' of sorts and underperformed at the Asian Games!

If you take some sporting disciplines, notably shooting, an Indian shooter winning a quota does not guarantee 100 per cent participation in the Olympics. There will still be Olympic selection trials, which can also be the case in boxing, wrestling and other sports. Ideally, the atmosphere has to be competitive and congenial. To read that some athletes 'tanked' in Nagoya or were unfit is distressing. Surely, no athlete wants to fly out, flop and come back. Those days are gone in Indian sport, hopefully.

We live in an age where data-driven facts flood us. Projections were made even before the Asian Games that India would win 130-plus medals. Whoever did that calculation, it flopped. So, the best approach is to let the top athletes represent India in 2028, which is around 20 months away. There is no certainty about who will be fit, who will be injury-free and who will not flunk a dope test. The worst fear is doping, since no sport is dope-free, thanks to that ugly desire to succeed because of cash awards and rewards. Look at how various states are throwing awards at medal-winning athletes. Haryana, Tamil Nadu and many more states are loosening their purse strings, while Karnataka is a miser.

INDIA'S OLYMPIC AMBITIONS EXTEND BEYOND MEDALS TO HOSTING THE WORLD'S BIGGEST SPORTING EVENT

And if athletes are cribbing about a lower cash component as a reward from their state, it's sad. At the end of the day, each athlete is representing India. Period. We saw massive flop shows at the Asian Games in badminton, tennis, equestrian and a few more sporting disciplines. How India ensures this will not happen at the Olympics in Los Angeles is a subject that our policymakers and the National Sports Federations have to deal with. We, in India, are still stuck with old names.

Neeraj Chopra, PV Sindhu, Mirabai Chanu and Manu Bhaker, champions all, will still be hyped as medal prospects in 2028. Right or wrong, do not ask, for this is the way to create hype. Pray, if you look at the medal winners from the Asian Games, fresh faces created a stir and took us by storm.

Planning for the LA Olympics has already begun. India has qualified in hockey, so the target should be building a core team for both the men's and women's sides. How boxers shape up, whether there can be another name ahead of Mirabai and whether India can hope to find more big names to do well in weightlifting are areas where work has to be done.

For sure, one sport that delivers medals for India at the Olympics is shooting. From Rajyavardhan Rathore winning a silver medal in double trap at the 2004 Athens Olympics to Abhinav Bindra winning gold in Beijing in 2008, the sequence was maintained. At the 2012 London Olympics, Gagan Narang won a bronze in rifle shooting and Vijay Kumar a silver. Yet, failures at the 2016 Olympics in Rio de Janeiro and the Tokyo Olympics in 2021 were sad. Manu Bhaker winning two bronze medals at the Paris 2024 Olympics, Sarabjot Singh also winning a mixed-team medal in air pistol and Swapnil Kusale clinching a rifle medal were highs.

Today, there are more shooters who can defeat the above-mentioned names in trials, the Nationals and even the Asian Games. That is the depth that exists in Indian shooting. But then, making shooters peak at the LA Olympics will be a challenge. Mission Possible, for sure, as we have talented shooters like Neeru Dhanda and more names in shotgun shooting. Where there is a gap between potential and performance, India may still need experts from overseas, be they coaches, mind trainers or other foreign specialists.

At a time when we are talking about performance and how India can emerge as a sporting power, there is another narrative emerging: how India wishes to host more big international sporting events. If you have followed the calendar in India, many important events have been hosted in the last year or so. That New Delhi is no longer the favourite host city, but Ahmedabad is, has become obvious.

Old-timers still wonder how and when Ahmedabad became a sports city. Yes, in cricket, the Narendra Modi Stadium, refurbished and redone in 2021, is a massive hit. The venue has hosted multiple ICC World Cup matches in the ODI and T20 formats. In addition, big cricket events have also shown Ahmedabad to be a lively city now.

So, if a strong pitch is being made by India to host the 2036 Summer Olympics in Ahmedabad, why not? The 2030 Commonwealth Games will be held in the same city. Ahmedabad is also looking at hosting the Asian Games in 2038. A final decision on it will come in a few years, not right away, from the Olympic Council of Asia.

It is pertinent to point out that India is being taken seriously by the International Olympic Committee (IOC). "Wherever the Games take place, one thing must never change: athletes have to be at the heart of everything we do," said IOC President Kirsty Coventry. "That is why, for every future host, delivering the best possible experience for the athletes must always be the starting point."

These words from Kirsty Coventry are important, as India will be pushing its case ahead in the next phase. Competing with Doha, Hungary, Germany and South Korea may look intimidating to a few back home in India. The reality is that India does have a chance. What happens from now until 2027, when the further shortlist will be announced, is significant.

Doha has enough money and has hosted big sporting events, from the Asian Games to the FIFA World Cup in 2022. However, money is not the sole factor that will decide. The war in the Gulf region, plus Iran and unrest in Saudi Arabia, will be impeding factors. In Doha, there are also strong restrictions in place over liquor policy, LGBTQ issues and a few more important points. This was highlighted by the world media as well.

Why does Ahmedabad have a chance? It is well known that, despite inflation and other issues, India hosting an Olympics is about more than pride. Costing is a factor, but there is no way you can say no to an Olympics bid. Then again, those who think India has to be a strong sporting nation, win a huge number of medals at the Summer Olympics and only then bid for an Olympics are wrong.

Not many would know that there are key factors in play that will decide the final 2036 Summer Olympics host city. The principles laid down for selecting Olympic hosts include Full Alignment, Flexibility, Transparency, Legacy and Continuity, and Collaboration and Partnership. All this is mentioned in an IOC document accessed by this writer.

To the layman, everything mentioned above may sound like jargon. How India is approaching the 2036 Summer Olympics is smart. Not everything has to be put out in the public domain. The timeline is as follows: In November 2026, there will be a virtual presentation by Interested Parties (Countries) to the Future Host Commission. By March 2027, there will be IOC Feasibility Assessments. Going forward, after that, there will be the opening of Strategic Dialogue by the International Olympic Committee Executive Board.

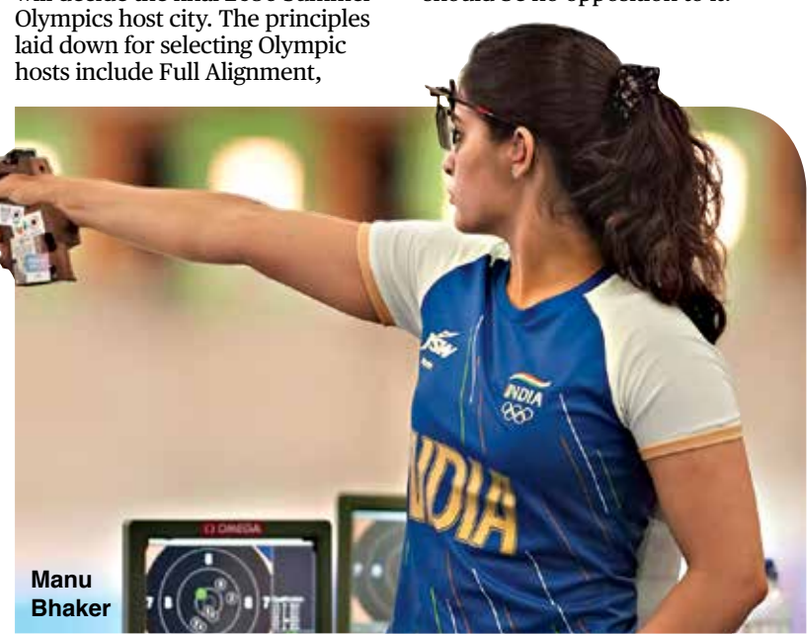
Everything is laid out in detail, and there is transparency. In the past, nations went bust hosting an Olympics. Even First World nations like France struggled to host the Olympics in 2024, when Paris was the host city. You can be dead sure Ahmedabad will not scrounge for funds.

Why this is important, the IOC knows. India is no longer a dark nation. The growth has been phenomenal. Folks who visit Ahmedabad regularly will tell you what changes have taken place there. Sports infrastructure is already being built on a lavish scale.

As Dr PT Usha, President of the Indian Olympic Association, said: "For us, 'Rising Together' is not simply a slogan – it is a powerful commitment to unite India's energy, ambition and diversity behind a shared Olympic dream.

"As we develop our vision for 2036, we want to create a Games that reflects the confidence of a young, dynamic and rising India, while contributing to the Olympic and Paralympic Movements' ambition to reach new generations, new communities and new horizons around the world."

Hopefully, India will go ahead with the 2036 Summer Olympics plan in a positive spirit. There should be no opposition to it.



Manu Bhaker



SHEFALI SHAH ON HER ROLE IN 'WAQT'

'JAYA JI WAS THE ORIGINAL CHOICE'

SHEFALI SAID HER HUSBAND, VIPUL SHAH, HAD ADVISED HER AGAINST TAKING THE ROLE OF A MOTHER IN HIS 2005 DIRECTORIAL 'WAQT'

NEW DELHI: Shefali Shah said her husband, Vipul Shah, had advised her against taking the role of a mother in his 2005 directorial 'Waqt' when she was barely in her 30s, but ended up doing the part after other casting choices fell through and Amitabh Bachchan recommended her name.

In the movie, she played Akshay Kumar's mother, though she was younger than him in real life. Her casting raised eyebrows at the time and ended up affecting the kind of roles that came her way.

Shah has now looked back at this chapter in her debut book, 'The Audacity of Being: A Sort-of Memoir'. According to the 53-year-old actress, Vipul originally wanted veteran actress Jaya Bachchan for the role. Hema Malini was also considered, but the idea was eventually dropped as it felt too similar to the Amitabh Bachchan-Hema Malini starrer 'Baghban', which was released in 2003.

"The mother, Sumi, was the anchor of the story - the silent strength between the father and the son. Vipul had originally wanted Jaya ji, but that did not work out. Hema Malini ji was another great choice, but it felt too much like a repeat of 'Baghban', a film that Amit ji and Hema ji had done only a while ago," Shah wrote.

'Waqt: The race against time', which also starred Priyanka Chopra, was based on 'Aavjo Vhala, Fari Malishu' (Goodbye, Dear, Until Next Time), a play written and directed by Aatish Kapadia.

Shah said she fell in love with the character of Sumi after watching the play and eventually asked Vipul if she could play the role. "He flatout said no and insisted it would not work, warning me that it would label me as a 'mother' on screen forever," she wrote.

THE SITUATION CHANGED AFTER AMITABH BACHCHAN, WHO WAS THE 'UNANIMOUS AND ONLY CHOICE' TO PLAY THE FATHER, SUGGESTED THAT VIPUL CONSIDER HER FOR THE ROLE

The situation changed after Bachchan, who was the 'unanimous and only choice' to play the father, suggested that Vipul consider her for the role. "Now, that was something Vipul could not turn down," she wrote.

Shah described the role as an 'opportunity of a lifetime', as it allowed her to work with two of her favourite people in the industry - Bachchan and Vipul.

In an interview with PTI, Shah acknowledged that playing an older character at that stage of her career had a lasting professional impact. "I was naive enough to think that people would see it as, you know, it would be admired. Like, 'Oh, wow, she can do this too, as an actor. She's as old as this and then she can play a role which is much older than her'. But that's not how it works. It's absolutely not how it works," Shah said.

"And it didn't. And it's not that I could pinpoint the blame on that particular decision. But I'm sure that decision had a lot to do with what I got offered after that," she told PTI.

In the book, Shah recounted how she feared being the industry's 'next Nirupa Roy', the late star known for playing self-sacrificing mother roles in films such as 'Deewar' and 'Amar Akbar Anthony'.

"After 'Waqt', I was bombarded with 'mommy' roles," she wrote, adding that she had made what, in hindsight, was not the best professional choice at a crucial stage of her career.

Despite the consequences, Shah said she continues to value 'Waqt' for giving her the opportunity to share screen space with Bachchan.

She recalled that she had once dreamed of standing outside his house just to see him wave. "He is a legend who is so humble and treats you as an equal, someone who puts you at ease," she wrote. PTI

When love turns into obsession...

'Ishqa Ishqa' offers an intense new take on love, obsession and the consequences of not letting go

OUR CORRESPONDENT



What happens when love stops being about trust and begins to feel like possession? Prime Video's 'MX Original' series 'Ishqa Ishqa' explores this unsettling question through a dark, emotionally charged story that blurs the line between love, obsession and control. Featuring a stellar cast including Helly Shah, Satyajeet Dubey and Anushka Kaushik in pivotal roles, the series follows a writer caught between two starkly different versions of love - one that draws him deeper into chaos and another that offers him peace and stability.

Here are four reasons why 'Ishqa Ishqa' deserves a spot on your watchlist:

A childhood dare that turns into a dangerous game: At the heart of 'Ishqa Ishqa' is a childhood rule called 'The Dare' between Arohi and Kabir, where a challenge, once given, cannot be refused. What begins as an innocent game gradually becomes the foundation of a relationship shaped by emotional intensity, control and obsession. When Kabir dares Arohi to stay away from him for a year, she accepts - only to return the moment that year is over, determined to resume their relationship from exactly where they left off. As the story progresses, 'The Dare' takes on a darker meaning, turning their relationship into a psychological game where choices have consequences and walking away is never quite as simple as it seems.

3 Characters caught between chaos, calm & control: Helly Shah, Satyajeet Dubey and Anushka Kaushik lead the series as Arohi, Kabir and Suhani, three characters at the centre of an increasingly complicated emotional conflict. While Arohi's intense and possessive love continues to pull Kabir into chaos, Suhani brings stability, trust and emotional clarity into his life. Caught between the two, Kabir must confront what he truly wants and what he is willing to lose to find it.

Helly Shah steps into a dark & unpredictable role: She steps into darker territory as Arohi, a woman for whom love is absolute, consuming and almost unquestionable. Intelligent, emotional and deeply strategic, Arohi is far more complex than simply being an obsessive lover. Her vulnerability exists alongside an unsettling need to control the people and circumstances around her. As her emotions intensify and her actions become increasingly unpredictable, Arohi's transformation brings a gripping psychological edge to the series and keeps viewers guessing about just how far she is willing to go for love.

A story that goes beyond a conventional love triangle: While 'Ishqa Ishqa' may begin with three people caught in an emotional conflict, its story goes beyond the familiar conventions of a love triangle. Through Kabir's relationships with Arohi and Suhani, the series explores contrasting ideas of chaos and stability, control and freedom and emotional addiction and healing. As Kabir finds himself torn between Arohi's consuming intensity and Suhani's grounded approach to love, the series raises a larger, more uncomfortable question: when does loving someone deeply cross the line into wanting to possess them?

With a dangerous dare at its centre, three characters caught between love and control and a relationship where the line between being loved and being possessed begins to disappear, 'Ishqa Ishqa' offers an intense new take on love, obsession and the consequences of not knowing when to let go.

THE GREAT BIRYANI DEBATE!



Suhel Seth, who has an opinion on everything under the sun and beyond, has triggered a sort of non-veg debate on 'X' by claiming that Kolkata's biryani is the best in India

ASIF ULLAH KHAN

MANY SUPPORTERS OF POTATOES CAME TO THE FORE, SAYING 'AALOO' NEVER TASTES SO GOOD IN BIRYANI. SOME BONGS TOOK THE DEBATE BACK TO THE BENGAL FAMINE

Suhel Seth, who has an opinion on everything under the sun and beyond, has triggered a sort of non-veg debate on 'X', formerly 'Twitter', by claiming that Kolkata's biryani is the best in India. Mohandas Pai, an ardent supporter of the Modi government, also jumped into the fray without understanding the political implications, as he stands very tall among Modi 'bhakts'. Calling Suhel's claim presumptuous, he invited Suhel to try Bengaluru's Donne Biryani. Umesh (Modi ka Parivar), in an unlikely polite manner, differed with them, saying 'naati biryani' is the best, with a caveat: "It depends where you eat."

Sanatana Rao from Hyderabad, who looks like a Sanatani from his profile, which says 'Urdhwapundra Madhwa, Upanishads, Vedas, Sanatana Temples', asked Suhel to try Hyderabadi Kachi Handi ki Biryani. Yashwant Deshmukh of C-Voter fame questioned Suhel's logic of having potato and eggs in biryani, saying, "If Aaloo-Bhaath was Biryani."

Many supporters of potatoes came to the fore, saying 'aaloo' never tastes so good in biryani. Some Bongs took the debate back to the Bengal famine. Sujata Suri says, "An egg, one aaloo and a piece of meat per plate makes it more affordable for the masses. If you dissect our Bong cuisine, you'll realise that much of it was influenced by the Bengal famine. We even cook the skins of potatoes and lauki! Nutritious too. Now it's (sic) our comfort food." Satavahana endorsed the Sujata theory, saying, "Aloo was introduced into biryani as a substitute for meat... As the Bengal famine pushed many into poverty..."

Nirav Kanodra totally debunked Suhel's assertion. "Best biryanis for someone is what they grew up eating. But it's actually one that travels well. Don't see Kolkata biryani spots elsewhere. Hyderabad and Lucknow biryanis are the only ones popular in the third location."

Malayaj, taking a potshot at Suhel, said, "Kolkata biryani is the worst form of biryani. Also good to know that even in food choices I stand on the opposite side of whatever that fatso Suhel Seth believes in." Ishaan Sinha, who has been living in Kolkata for the past four years, said, "4 years in Bengal, 7 among its people and I found myself compatible with almost everything Bengal: its food, its people, its culture. But Kolkata Biryani is that one damn thing I just couldn't warm myself up to. Rice is too bland and that giant potato is mehh. Just didn't cut."

But Suhel, as he always wants to have the last word, cut the debate, saying, "Just saying it here. The best biryani in India is the Kolkata style Biryani with a potato and an egg. Nothing else compares. End of debate."

The debate on great Indian biryani is going on 'X', with everyone overruling each other's claims, but unlike TV channel debates, the language and the decibel level remain very civil. But this entire delicious debate was 'spoiled' (pun intended) by a putrid remark by Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, who said that 'those born to eat biryani are animals'. Coming from a man who just a few months ago had no problems with people eating beef at home, it left a bad taste in the mouth.

One is sure this remark must have hurt Suhel's sentiments. Suhel, who is proud of his English, needs to find a new word in his vocabulary to give Sarma a mouthful.

